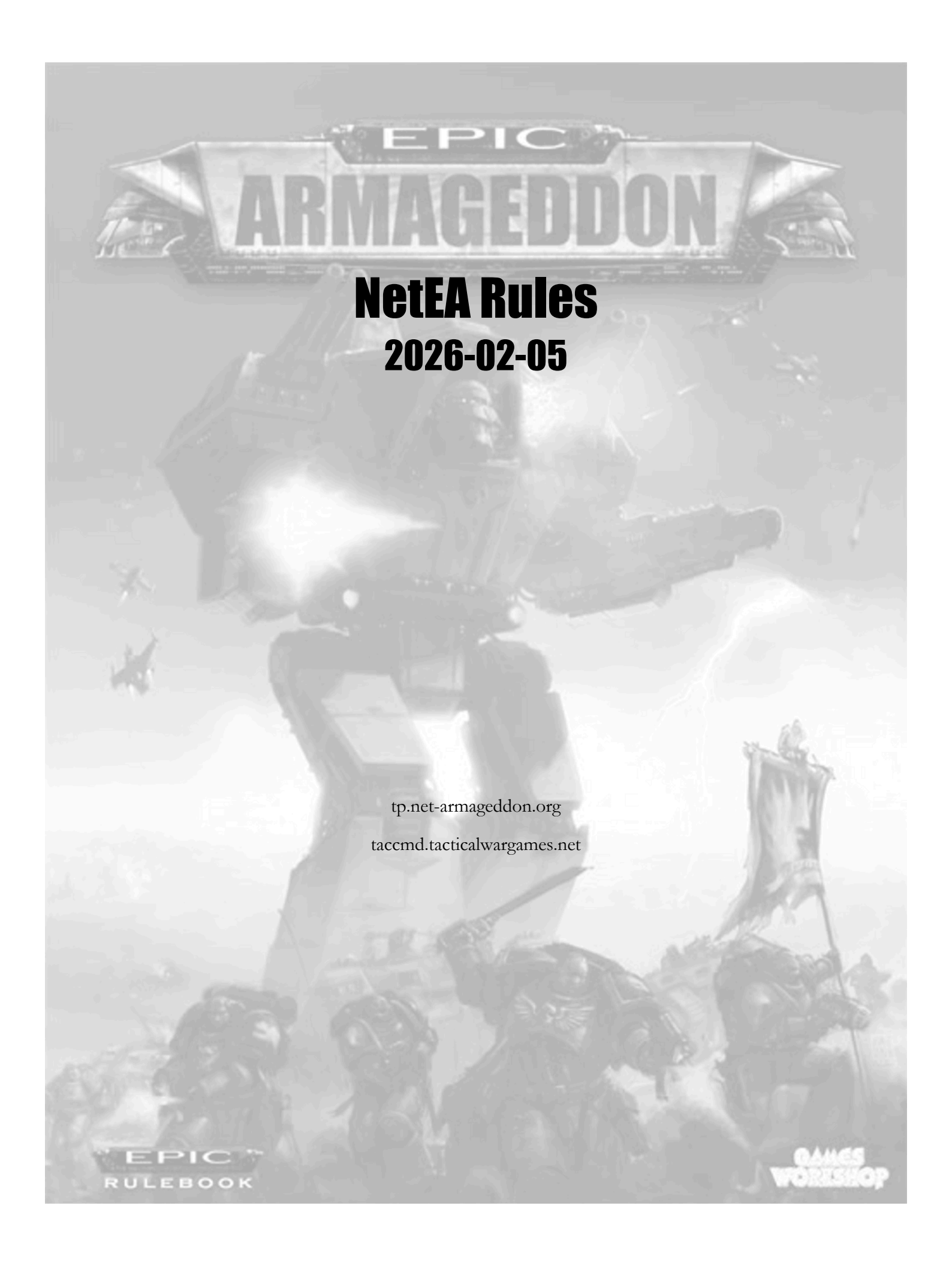


The background of the page is a grayscale illustration of a giant robot, the God King, standing amidst a battlefield. The robot is holding a glowing sword in its right hand and a large gun in its left. In the foreground, there are several smaller figures, including a warrior on a horse holding a banner. The overall scene is one of intense battle.

EPIC ARMAGEDDON

NetEA Rules **2026-02-05**

tp.net-armageddon.org

taccmd.tacticalwargames.net

EPIC
RULEBOOK

GAMES
WORKSHOP

What is NetEA?

Net Epic Armageddon, or NetEA, is the name of the Tactical Wargame Network's development of fan-made rule extensions, army lists and army list updates for Games Workshop's Epic Armageddon. The main focus of NetEA is to clarify the rules of Epic Armageddon and balance its tournament army lists against one another for the fun and enjoyment of all.

What is the Tournament Pack?

The NetEA Tournament Pack consists of the following:

- The Epic Armageddon game rules and **all** of the errata that used to be found on Games Workshop's Epic Armageddon Resources web page. All is stressed here as some errata was missing from the rulebook sections that used to be found on the web page above.
- The most up-to-date FAQ available, essentially an expanded version of the FAQ that used to be found on the web page above. Each Q&A is a footnote in the appropriate section of the rules.
- All of the NetEA Approved tournament army lists and any rule extensions and Q&A's that accompany them. NetEA Approved army lists are tournament ready and balanced against one another using the Epic tournament game rules.

Will the Tournament Pack be updated?

Yes. The plan is to update the Tournament Pack every month, as needed.

Which version of the Tournament Pack is this?

Each Tournament Pack has its publication date on most of its pages, this is how it is versioned.

Where can I get the latest version of the Tournament Pack?

The NetEA Tournament Pack website (tp.net-armageddon.org).

What's the best way to print the Tournament Pack?

Doubled-sided at 100% on either letter or A4-sized paper.

What's a good forum for all things Epic?

Tactical Command (taccmd.tacticalwargames.net) is, hands down, the best Epic forum there is.

I found an error/typo, where should I report it?

The TacComm forums.

Where can I find more Epic army lists?

TacComm has tons of them, and many are included in the NetEA Army List Compendium found on the NetEA website (net-armageddon.org). They are clearly labelled as NetEA Approved, Developmental and Experimental so you have an idea on how well play-tested each list is. In addition, be sure to check out Epic-UK (epic-uk.co.uk) or epic_fr (epic-fr.niceboard.com) to see what the locals in your area are using.

Where can I buy Epic models?

At this point, the various forums that have been listed, eBay or Bartertown is your best bet for the out-of-print models. However, there are many 6mm science fiction manufacturers with products that make excellent proxies for Epic units. Most post on the TacComm forums.

Is this thing Games Workshop "official"?

Yes and no. While the rules presented here are those found in the Epic Armageddon rulebook, the FAQs have been expanded upon based on what is available from Games Workshop.

Additionally, the army lists presented here will have some price and composition differences when compared to what used to be provided on Games Workshop's website. These changes were all done in the name of balance and have the support of the TacComm community. For the most part they are fairly minimal and should not be viewed as "game changing/breaking".

Are the rules that used to be on Games Workshop's Epic Armageddon Resources web page available anywhere?

Yes, they are on the NetEA website (net-armageddon.org).

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1.0 EPIC GAME RULES

“It is the purest folly to believe that an individual can save Armageddon. Wars are not won by heroes, they are won by firepower and force, and the application of strategy and tactics.”

Commissar Yarrick

On the following pages you will find the core rules for the Epic game system, covering all of the basic mechanics of the Epic game. The core rules describe how units (that’s to say any kind of infantry or armoured vehicles) move and fire on each other and participate in assaults.

Scattered through the rules you will occasionally find Special Rule boxes. Most special rules are described in rules sections 2.0–4.0, but some rules you really need to know about earlier on and because of this we’ve included them with the core rules. You will also find Design Concept boxes that explain certain fundamental principles of the rules. We’ve put these off to one side rather than include them in the rules proper in order to save repetition, and also to allow us to explain in rather more detail the concepts and philosophy behind the rules. The author feels quite strongly that disputes or misinterpretation of the rules can be minimised if you understand why a rule is written the way it is.

We highly recommend that you play several games using the core rules before fighting battles using the full range of Epic scale vehicle and infantry miniatures that use the special rules. In order to help with this we’ve included a number of “training scenarios” at the end of the core rules that will allow you to try the rules out quickly and easily.

1.0.1 What You Will Need to Play

In order to play you will need to get hold of Epic scale miniatures. These miniatures are available from Games Workshop stores and Direct Sales as well as independent specialist hobby shops.

You will also need a small amount of gaming terrain. You can use the hills and trees made for Warhammer or Warhammer 40,000 and available from the same places as Epic miniatures if you don’t have any Epic scale terrain, or just lay a cloth over some books to create rolling, hilly terrain. Forge World sells a wide array of detailed resin terrain pieces to expand the boundaries of your battle settings.

In addition to models, a suitable battlefield, and players you’ll need a few more essential items to begin play:

Templates: Certain weapons in Epic, such as the huge Imperial Earthshaker Cannon, have an area effect rather than targeting a specific unit. These attacks are represented by placing a circular template over the target and attempting to affect any units under it. Two types of template are used in Epic, a Barrage template that has a diameter of 7.4cm, and a larger Orbital Bombardment template that has a diameter of 12cm. The type and intensity of the attack will dictate which template is used and how many templates may be required. Copies of both templates can be found at the end of the core rules, or you can use the plastic Blast and Ordnance templates produced by Games Workshop. You can also make your own versions of the templates from card

or acetate.

Measuring Instrument: You will need some kind of measuring instrument marked in centimetres (cms) in order to play Epic. You will find a retractable measuring tape most useful for measuring movement and shooting distances. If you only have a measuring instrument marked in inches then you can use it by halving any distances measured in centimetres and using the result as a distance in inches instead. For example, if the rules said 5cm you would count this as 2.5" instead. Please note that if you decide to measure any distances in inches then both players must do so!

Paper and Pens or Pencils: You may need to record details of casualties and damage to those gigantic war engines occasionally during a game, so it’s useful to have some paper and a writing implement handy.

Dice: In Epic you’ll need buckets full of ordinary six-sided dice to resolve shooting and fighting in an assault. These are referred to as a D6. If you need to roll more than one dice, then this is written as 2D6 (for roll two dice) or 4D6 (for roll four dice) and so on. If you have to add something to the total of the roll, this is added afterwards. For example, D6+6 means roll one dice and add 6 to the score to get a total between 7 and 12. If asked to roll a D3 simply roll a D6 and count a roll of 1–2 as a 1, a roll of 3–4 as a 2, and a roll of 5–6 as a 3. In some cases a unit or formation will need to roll a 1 or higher on a D6. In this case the roll automatically succeeds and no dice roll is strictly necessary (though you can roll anyway if you wish!).

Blast Markers: An army in battle tends to get worse at fighting as it is subjected to enemy fire and loses close combats. In Epic, Blast markers represent this. You can either make your own Blast markers, or use the Battle Markers produced by Games Workshop, or keep track of things with paper and pencil or some other method if you prefer. As long as you know how many Blast markers a formation has accumulated during the game then whatever method you use is fine with us!

1.1 UNITS

Epic lets you fight battles with everything from lowly infantry to the terrifying war engines that dominate the battle zones of the 41st Millennium. From the smallest to the greatest, every warrior and weapon has its part to play. Different types of unit complement one another in combat—war engines fighting in cities need infantry to enter buildings and drive out enemy troops, infantry in the open need support from their own tanks and war engines lest they be swept away by enemy war engines.

No matter what their size, the Citadel miniatures used to play Epic are referred to as units in the rules that follow. Each unit is an individual playing piece with its own capabilities. A unit may consist of a single model tank, a gigantic war engine, or several infantry models mounted together on a single base, but in the rules all of these things are simply referred to as units.

IMPORTANT: The core rules on the following pages only cover infantry and armoured vehicles. The rules for specialist units in Section 2.0 introduce several new unit types and characteristics, rules for Titans and other war engines are introduced in Section 3.0, and rules for aircraft in Section 4.0.

1.1.1 Unit Types

All units in the core rules are subdivided into two broad categories: Infantry and Armoured Vehicles.

Infantry (INF): This designation includes all personnel not mounted inside a vehicle. Infantry are represented by between three and seven Epic infantry models mounted on a single base (see 1.1.2 for details). Field artillery such as Ork Big Gunz also fall into this category, as do infantry that ride on bikes or horses.

Armoured Vehicles (AV): As their name implies, these vehicles are covered with thick armour plate. The category includes tanks such as Lemman Russ and Land Raiders, as well as armoured troop carriers like the Rhino. Armoured vehicles are represented by a single model.

1.1.2 Stands

As previously noted, a unit can be a single vehicle model, or a *stand* made up of several very small models grouped together and glued to a small base. Stands usually represent things like infantry, where moving the individual models round on their own would be very fiddly with Epic scale models. All the models glued to a stand count as a single unit as far as the rules are concerned. The size of a stand and the number of models glued to it are left pretty much up to the player to decide within the following limitations:

- A stand may be no more than 40mm and no less than 5mm across in any direction.
- A stand must be at least 20mm across in one direction (i.e., a 5mm by 5mm stand is not allowed, but a 5mm by 20mm stand would be okay).
- Stands representing infantry units must have at least three infantry models and may not have more than seven. Infantry mounted on bikes or horses must have between two and four models mounted on each base.
- Stands representing artillery must have between one and two artillery pieces and up to six crew models.

1.1.3 Unit Datasheets¹

Each unit in Epic has a datasheet that tells you how fast, shooty and tough the unit is. Each datasheet provides the following information:

Type: What target type the unit belongs to.

Speed: The speed of the unit. This is the distance in centimetres the unit can move each turn while still firing its weapons fairly effectively. It is possible for units to move faster than this if you wish, but their shooting will be far less effective.

Armour: This number shows how well protected and/or difficult to damage the unit is. If a hit is scored on the unit then you must roll this number or higher on a D6 to “save” the unit from the damage.

Close Combat: This number shows how effective the unit is at close combat. It is used when the unit charges an enemy unit, or is charged itself.

Firefight: This shows how effective the unit is when involved in a short-ranged firefight.

Weapons: This section of the data sheet lists what weapons the unit carries. If a unit carries more than one of a type of weapon then this will be noted as a “multiplier” by the weapon’s name. For example, a Space Marine Tactical squad is noted as having a “Missile Launcher”, while a Space Marine Devastator squad is noted as having “2× Missile Launcher”.

Range: The range of the weapon in centimetres.

Firepower: The numbers here represent how effective the weapon is when it shoots. Firepower comes in two “flavours”: Anti-personnel (abbreviated to AP) and Anti-tank (abbreviated to AT). AP fire is used against infantry targets and AT fire against armoured vehicles. A weapon that has both an AP and an AT value may choose to use either one when it attacks, but may not use both in the same turn.

The value listed for a weapon is the score required on a single D6 to score a hit. Most weapons only roll one D6 to hit when they shoot. However, if a weapon’s firepower value is preceded by a multiplier then a number of dice equal to the multiplier should be rolled instead. For example, a weapon with a firepower of “AP5+” would roll one D6 to hit, while a unit with a firepower of “3× AP5+” would roll three D6. Sometimes the entry will specify a dice roll rather than a fixed number. For example, a weapon that had “D3× AP5+” would attack D3 times each time it was used.

Special Rules: Some weapons have additional abilities (see 2.0) and may have limited fire arcs (see Weapon Fire Arcs).

Notes: If any special rules apply to the unit then they will be

1. Unit Datasheets

Q: What is the difference between AND/OR designations on weapons?

A: A weapon designated as “OR” may choose between the modes of fire on the datasheet each time it is used. A weapon designated as “AND” may use all modes of fire simultaneously each time it is used.

Q: Some units can be armed with one weapon or another, when are these chosen?

A: When both players pick armies (6.1.1).

noted here. An explanation of what effect these rules have can be found in sections 2.0–4.0.

Datasheets for units from the Epic Game can be found in Section 5.0.

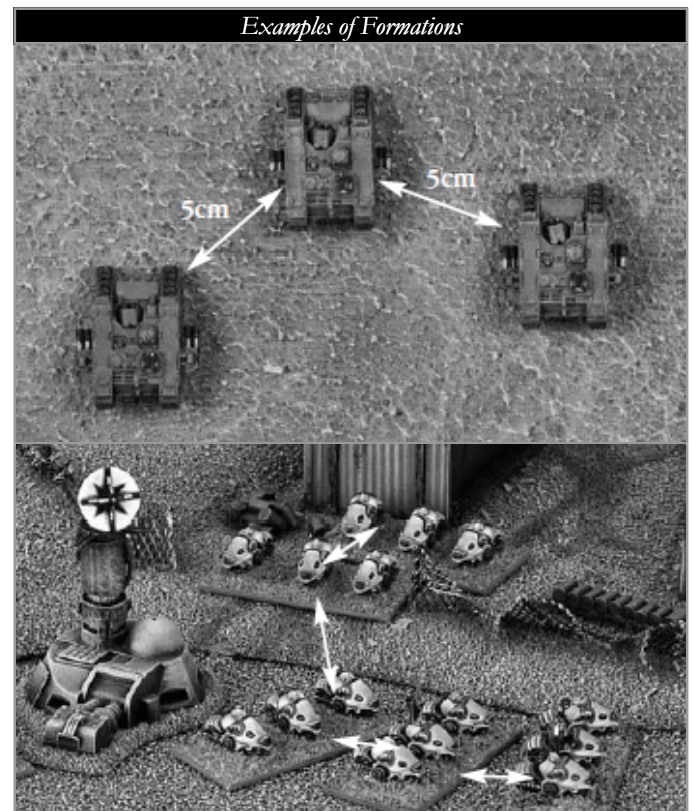
1.2 FORMATIONS

On the battlefield, vehicles and troops don't just mill around individually, instead they are organised so that they fight as a unified whole. In Epic, a body of troops and war machines that fights together on the battlefield is referred to as a *formation*.

1.2.1 Formations

All units must be organised into formations at the start of the game. The scenarios included in these rules will tell you what formations each side may use. If you are devising your own scenario then you must decide what formations the units taking part will fight in before the battle begins.

Every unit in a formation must be no further than 5cm from at least one other unit in the same formation. In addition, all units must form a “chain” without any gaps of more than 5cm. Sometimes the units in a formation will become separated due to enemy fire or assault. When this happens, the formation *must* close back up again into a legal formation when it next takes an action (see 1.6.1).



1.2.2 Initiative Values

Each formation has an *initiative value* that represents how well trained and motivated it is. The lower a formation's initiative value is, the better (e.g., an initiative of 1 is better than an initiative of 2). Formations with good initiative values are more likely to carry out orders, and will rally more quickly than formations with worse initiative values. You will find that a formation's initiative value is one of its most important characteristics. Some example initiative values are shown below:

Formation	Initiative Value
Space Marine	1+
Imperial Guard	2+
Ork	3+

1.3 BLAST MARKERS

During a game of Epic the formations under your command will receive *Blast markers* when they come under fire, take casualties, fight in assaults, or fail initiative tests. Blast markers can be removed when a formation rallies or regroups (see 1.13 and 1.14.1). The effects of blast markers will make more sense when you have read the rest of the rules, but in summary:

- A formation receives one Blast marker every time it is shot at by an enemy formation, even if no casualties are caused, unless the rules specifically state otherwise.
- In addition, a formation receives one Blast marker every time a unit is destroyed, unless the rules specifically state otherwise.
- Each Blast marker suppresses one unit in the formation and stops it from shooting. Blast markers also affect a formation's ability to carry out actions, win assaults, and rally. A formation is broken when the number of Blast markers equals the number of units in the formation, unless the rules specifically state otherwise. A broken formation has to withdraw, and is not allowed to take actions in the action phase (which basically means it can't move or shoot). It must try to rally in the end phase.

Blast Marker Table

<i>Blast Markers</i>	<i>Result</i>	<i>Effect</i>
Each Blast Marker	Unit <i>Suppressed</i>	May not shoot
One per unit	Formation <i>Broken</i>	Withdraw

DESIGN CONCEPT

Blast Markers

Blast markers are an attempt to show in a simple and playable manner that the psychological effect of fire is every bit as important, if not more important, than the actual number of casualties caused. Blast markers represent a whole range of personal disasters occurring to the units in a formation: things being damaged, squads being scattered, breaking or fleeing, and so on. They are a vital part of Epic so don't overlook their importance. The rules for Blast markers reflect the fact that most troops will tend to grind to a halt and seek cover when they come under even quite a small amount of fire (that's why a single sniper can slow down many times his own number of enemy troops), but will only withdraw when a combination of casualties and sustained enemy pressure convinces them that their position is untenable and they should withdraw (which is why a single sniper will rarely drive the enemy off).

1.4 SEQUENCE OF PLAY

An Epic battle is fought over a number of turns. How many turns a battle will last is determined by the players themselves or the scenario being fought.

Epic uses the following *sequence of play*. As you can see, each turn in Epic Armageddon is split into three phases. However, the bulk of the action occurs, appropriately enough, in the action phase. During this phase, the players take it in turn to pick one of the formations in their armies and carry out an action with it. Each formation in an army can carry out one action. After both players have taken one action with each of their formations, they move onto the end phase. This is basically a “tidy-up” phase, where things that are not carried out during the action phase are sorted out. Note that both players do things in each phase, so both carry out actions in the action phase, rally broken formations in the end phase, and so on.

1.4.1 Sequence of Play

I – Strategy Phase: Each player rolls a D6 and adds their army’s strategy rating to the score. Whoever scores higher may choose to go first or second in the action phase.

II – Action Phase: The players alternate carrying out actions with their units.

III – End Phase: Both players rally formations with Blast markers or that are broken, and then check the scenario victory conditions to see if either side has won.

1.4.2

*Abilities Used at Start of Turn/Action*²

Some units have special abilities that are specified as taking effect at the beginning of the turn. These effects are resolved before the Strategy roll. Similarly, abilities that are used at the start of an action can be taken before the Initiative roll is made or the action chosen. If both players have effects for the beginning of the turn, take turns resolving them starting with the player with the higher Strategy rating, alternating between players for each subsequent effect until all effects are resolved.

1.5 THE STRATEGY PHASE³

Each army has a *strategy rating*. This will either be listed in the notes for a scenario, or can be found in the army list if you are playing a tournament game. An army’s strategy rating represents a mixture of its aggression and the ability of its commanders. An army with a high strategy rating is more likely to act before an enemy with a lower strategy rating.

In the strategy phase at the start of each turn both players make a strategy roll by rolling a D6 and adding their strategy rating to the score. The player whose army scores higher can choose to go first or second in the action phase. In the case of a tie, the side that failed to win the initiative last turn gets it on this turn.

DESIGN CONCEPT

Ties

In the case of a tie or any situation where the rules allow both players to do something at the same time, the player with the next birthday gets to go first unless the rules specifically say otherwise.

2. Abilities Used at Start of Turn/Action

Q: Can the player with the higher strategy rating choose to make their opponent go first?

A: Yes.

Q: What happens when both armies have formations with the same ability used at the start of the turn and the same strategy rating?

A: Dice to see who chooses to go first.

Q: Should you dice for each ability (e.g. teleport, tunneler, etc.) used at the start of the turn?

A: Bring it up in the five minute warm-up.

3. The Strategy Phase

Q: What is the order of events that happen in the Strategy Phase?

A: If alternating, the player with the higher strategy rating chooses who will go first.

1. Units with tunneler surface (alternate)
2. Units with teleport are placed, other “start of turn” abilities go into effect (alternate)
3. Make a strategy roll (simultaneous)

1.6 THE ACTION PHASE

In the action phase, the players take it in turns to carry out actions with their unbroken formations. Each unbroken formation can take one action per turn. The player that won the strategy roll can choose whether to go first or second.

The player going first then carries out an action with one formation, and then their opponent does likewise, and so on until all formations have taken an action. If one player runs out of formations to activate, then the opposing player may keep on activating formations one after the other until all of his formations have taken an action.

There are three steps to carrying out an action:

I – Nominate a formation.

II – Declare which action it will carry out.

III – The formation must then pass an action test to see if it carries out the action successfully.

Each of these steps is explained in more detail below. Note that you must declare both the formation and the action it will carry out before taking the Action test. If you fail to do these things, then the formation chosen automatically fails the Action test without the dice being rolled (we can imagine this is due to a communications failure). If you failed to even nominate the formation then your opponent may nominate the formation for you.

1.6.1 Actions

To carry out an action, first nominate an unbroken formation and then choose an action for it to carry out. The actions that can be chosen are listed as follows. Note that you must activate a formation if you can, you can't choose to "pass" unless you have no choice in the matter. Also note that a formation may only be activated once per Action phase.

Advance: The formation may make one move and then shoot.

Engage: The formation may make one "charge" move and then fight an assault.

Double: The formation may make two moves and then shoot with a -1 modifier.

March: The formation may make three moves.

Marshal: The formation may either shoot with a -1 modifier and then regroup, or make one move and then regroup. Regrouping allows the formation to remove some of the Blast markers affecting the formation (see 1.13).

Overwatch: The formation may not move, but instead enters overwatch. Being on overwatch allows the formation to interrupt an enemy formation's action to shoot at it. You may not choose this action if the formation has any units that are out of formation.

Sustained Fire: The formation may not move (not even to turn in place), but can shoot with a +1 modifier. You may not choose this action if the formation has any units that are out of formation.

In addition to these basic actions, there are two more special types of action a formation may make:

Hold: This action is the only one allowed to a formation that fails an Action test (see the rules for action tests next). The formation may make one move or shoot or regroup. You must choose to move if any units are out of formation.

Special Actions: Some formations are allowed to carry out special actions. Some of these are described in the Special Rules section of this rulebook, or they may be included in the rules for a scenario.

1.6.2 The Action Test ⁴

Before a formation can carry out an action it must pass an action test. Broken formations may not take an action. Instead they must pass a rally test in the end phase in order to rally. See the rules for broken formations (1.13) later on.

To pass an action test, you must roll equal to or over the formation's initiative value on a D6. If the formation passes the action test, it may carry out the stated action. If the formation fails the test, it can still carry out a hold action (even if the player nominated something else), but the formation receives a Blast marker. There is a -1 modifier to the action test if the formation has one or more Blast markers, and a further -1 modifier if the formation is trying to retain the initiative (see 1.6.3).

1.6.3 Retaining the Initiative

Once you have successfully carried out an action with a formation, you may if you wish try to retain the initiative and take two actions in a row. If you decide to retain the initiative then you must nominate a new formation and declare the action it will carry out, but the formation will suffer a -1 modifier to its action test. Note: If the first formation fails its action, you may not attempt to retain the initiative—i.e., you may only attempt to retain the initiative after a successful action.

You must hand over the initiative after you have completed the action for a formation that retained the initiative (i.e., you can't retain the initiative twice in a row). The only exception to this is if one player has no formations left to activate. In this case, the other player may keep on activating formations without suffering the -1 modifier for retaining the initiative until all of the opposing formations have taken an action.

4. The Action Test

Q: When rolling an action test does a result of 1 automatically fail?

A: No.

EXAMPLE OF PLAY

Actions

After setting up their forces, the Ork player (Matt) and the Imperial Guard player (Bill) both roll a dice and add their strategy rating. The Imperial Guard player rolls a 6, to which he adds his strategy rating of 2 for a total of 8. The Ork player rolls a 3 on the dice, plus his strategy rating of 3, giving him a total of 6. The Imperial Guard player hence wins the strategy phase and may choose whether to go first or second. He chooses to go first.

The action phase now begins and the Imperial Guard player nominates the formation with which he will attempt his first action.

He picks a Steel Legion Mechanised Infantry Company out on the left flank and declares that they are going to attempt a double action. The chosen formation are members of the Imperial Guard, and therefore have an initiative rating of 2+. The player rolls the dice and scores a 4—the action is successful and the formation makes its chosen action (in this case, moving twice up the flank. They then have the option to shoot but can't see any enemy so the formation's action is at an end).

The Imperial Guard player then decides he is going to try to retain the initiative.

He nominates a Steel Legion Super Heavy Tank Company on the other side of the battlefield and declares that they are also going to attempt a double action. The player rolls a dice and scores a 2—the action fails, since the formation has an Initiative of 2, and suffers -1 to its dice roll for retaining the initiative. The formation receives a Blast marker and must take a hold action instead of taking the double action.

Action Test Table

Formation has at least one Blast marker		-1
Formation is trying to retain the initiative		-1
<i>Action Test Result</i>	<i>Actions</i>	<i>Notes</i>
Pass Action Test	Any	Player may attempt to retain the initiative (see 1.6.3).
Fail Action Test	Hold	Formation receives one Blast marker. Player may not attempt to retain the initiative.

1.7 MOVEMENT⁵

Most actions allow all the units in a formation to make one or more moves. Units move a distance in centimetres up to the Speed value shown on their datasheet—there is no compulsion on players to use the total move available to them. Depending on the action they are taking, a unit may move one, two or three times (see 1.7.1). They may turn freely as they move. A unit is never forced to move, but sometimes failing to do so can result in its destruction (see 1.13.3). Once a player has moved a unit and removed his hand from the model, the move may not be changed.

1.7.1 Multiple Moves

If an action allows units to make multiple moves, take each move one after the other, following the rules that follow for each move (i.e., don't simply add the movement distances together). For example, a Space Marine Tactical detachment (Speed 15cms) taking a March action would make three moves of 15cm each, rather than one move of 45cms.

1.7.2 Other Units

Enemy units may never move over or through each other. With the exception of infantry, a friendly unit may never move directly over another friendly unit. You can move over infantry units with other units, as the stationary infantry are assumed to get out of the way. Note that “moving over” refers to the model itself, not the unit's base.

1.7.3 Zones of Control⁶

All units in Epic have a zone of control that extends 5cm in every direction from the model. Models mounted on a stand may measure the zone of control from any model on the stand.

Units may not enter an enemy zone of control while they move, unless they are undertaking an engage action and use their charge move to get into base contact with the nearest enemy unit whose zone of control they have entered. Once a unit has been contacted by an engaging enemy unit, it loses its own zone of control for the rest of that engage action (including the ensuing assault). This will allow other units to move round it. Units are never allowed to cross directly over an enemy unit, even if it has lost its zone of control.

If a unit finds itself in an enemy zone of control for any reason, then it must either charge the enemy or leave the zone of control when it next takes an action (note that this will require an action that allows it to charge or move).

1.7.4 Formations

Any units that are out of formation for any reason after a formation has taken the movement part of its action are destroyed. The controlling player may choose which units are “out of formation” and destroyed. Note that each unit lost will place one Blast marker on the main part of the formation. This applies after each individual move, so if a formation made a march action, you can't wait until the end of all three moves in order to bring units back into formation—any out of formation units are destroyed at the end of the first move (and again at the end of the second and third moves if any other units have also ended up out of formation following the move).

5. Movement

Q: Can units move off the gaming table?

A: Only if specifically allowed to do so by a special rule.

Q: Can I choose to move a unit 0cm? If so, is it still susceptible to overwatch?

A: Yes and yes. Any action that includes one of more moves (advance, engage, double, march and possibly marshal, hold and special actions) is considered a move for the purposes of overwatch, even if units moved 0cm.
Note that withdrawals are optional however, and that a player can choose not to move a broken formation at all, thus avoiding overwatch.

6. Zones of Control

Q: If a unit finds itself in an enemy zone of control is it obligated to leave it via the shortest possible path?

A: No, the unit just needs to leave the zone of control before the end of the action.

Q: Can a unit be exactly 5cm away from an enemy unit?

A: No, the unit must be more than 5cm away from enemy unit, otherwise it would be in the enemy's zone of control.

Q: If a formation is within an enemy formation's zone of control can it engage another enemy formation?

A: Yes, so long as it completely leaves the first enemy formation's zone of control with the “charge” move.

1.7.5

Transport Vehicles⁷

Many formations include transport vehicles that can be used to carry other units that belong to the same formation. The number and type of units that can be carried will be listed on the transport vehicle's datasheet. Transport vehicles may only carry units from their own formation. Transport vehicles can pick up and carry units as part of the transport vehicle's move. The vehicle simply moves into base contact with the unit to be picked up, and then carries on with its move as normal. Note that the transported unit is not allowed to move themselves during the move when they are picked up.

Transported units may disembark at the end of any move after the move in which it was picked up. This happens after any overwatch shots (see 1.10) but before the moving formation shoots or assaults. Disembarking units may be placed within 5cms of the transport vehicle. If the formation has engage orders then they may be placed in base contact with an enemy unit. Otherwise they may not be placed within an enemy unit's zone of control. Note that units do not have to disembark, and may remain in their transport if they prefer. Units may not be picked up and disembark as part of the same move, though a formation making multiple moves as part of a march or double action could pick up units in one move and drop them off as part of a subsequent move. Units may embark or disembark as part of a counter-charge move (see 1.12.4), unless the transport vehicle carrying them is already in base contact with two enemy units—in which case they must stay on board (they are trapped inside!).

Units being transported may not shoot unless the transport vehicle's datasheet specifically says otherwise. Transported units are counted towards the number of units in the formation for all rules purposes (i.e., when working out the number of units involved in an assault or if the formation is broken by Blast markers, etc.). If the transport unit is destroyed, then any transported units may make their normal armour save OR make a 6+ cover save. See 2.2.6 if a transport is destroyed by a macro-weapon.

Please note that a transport vehicle that is being transported cannot transport other units itself (i.e., the "Russian Doll" tactic is not allowed!).

7. Transport Vehicles

Q: Does a transported unit lose its zone of control?

A: Yes.

Q: Are transported units considered to be in specific transporting units of their formation?

A: You can play it either way, just bring it up in the five minute warm up.

Q: Can a transport unit pick up a unit that is in terrain that is dangerous to the transport unit?

A: Yes, but if the unit being picked up was completely within the dangerous terrain then the transport would have to take a dangerous terrain test.

Q: Can a transport unit pick up a unit that is in terrain that is impassable to the transport unit?

A: Yes, but only if the unit being picked up is not completely within the impassable terrain.

Q: When disembarking, are transported units placed completely within 5cm of the transport unit or just so one part of the transported unit is within 5cm of the transport unit.

A: You can play it either way, just bring it up in the five minute warm up.

Q: How do transported units that are immobile or which have a speed of 0cm disembark?

A: As normal.

Q: Where are transported units placed when the unit transporting them is destroyed?

A: Where the unit transporting them was.

Q: What happens to transported units when the unit transporting them is destroyed by: dangerous terrain, the result of an assault, or an additional hit from a Blast marker on a broken formation?

A: They make their normal armour save or a 6+ cover save, the formation they are part of would not receive a Blast marker for any of these saves if they failed.

Q: What happens to transported units when the unit transporting them is destroyed by ending its second withdrawal move within 15cm of the enemy?

A: If they're broken and not fearless they will be destroyed. Otherwise they make their normal armour save or a 6+ cover save.

Q: If a transport is destroyed by a hit with a special ability does that carry over to the transported units?

A: Yes, the transported units save is affected by the type of hit the transport is destroyed by. For example, an ignore cover hit would prevent the transported units from making a 6+ cover save.

Q: If a transported unit does not have to disembark to shoot or use their firefight value, where are they considered to be?

A: Measure to the unit transporting them for the purposes of determining line of fire, range and suppression of the transported units. If the transported units are not able to physically fit on the transport unit's model use an off-board piece of card to show their relative position for the purposes of suppression.

1.8 TERRAIN

The galaxy is a vast place with millions of different worlds. The terrain covering these worlds can vary from empty plains to sky-scraping hive cities, and from verdant jungles to arid ash-waste deserts. Only one factor is common to them all, and that is that they all have areas where it is difficult to wage war!

In Epic, terrain affects units in one of three ways:

- The terrain has no effect on the unit when it moves through it.
- The terrain is impassable to the unit so it cannot move through the terrain under any circumstances.
- The terrain is dangerous to the unit, so the unit can enter the terrain but it might take damage (see 1.8.1).

The Terrain Effects table on the next page details some common types of terrain and the effects they have on different types of unit. How to represent terrain on the battlefield is discussed later on in this rulebook.

1.8.1 Dangerous Terrain Test⁸

Roll a D6 when you enter dangerous terrain, or when you start to move if already in dangerous terrain. On a roll of 1, the unit is destroyed with no save allowed, but the formation it is part of does not receive a Blast marker.

Units may choose to move through dangerous terrain cautiously. A unit that is moving cautiously counts as having a speed of 5cm, but is allowed to re-roll any Dangerous Terrain tests that it fails.

DESIGN CONCEPT

Terrain Conventions

It is possible to have all kinds of arguments about whether terrain partially or fully blocks the line of fire to a target. Because of this, you should discuss the terrain on your gaming table with your opponent before a game starts and make sure you both agree on how it will work with regard to this and any of the other terrain rules. However, the -1 to hit modifier should be generously applied, and if in any doubt it should be counted rather than ignored.

1.8.2 Cover to Hit Modifiers⁹

Units that are in terrain that is tall enough to at least partially obscure them from an attacker's view receive a -1 to hit modifier when being shot at (see 1.9.5). The to hit modifier also applies if intervening terrain obscures the target partially from view.

1.8.3 Infantry Cover Saves

Certain terrain is noted as giving infantry a cover save. While in such terrain, the infantry receive the cover save listed on the Terrain table in addition to the -1 to hit modifier for being in cover. The cover save can be used instead of their normal armour save whenever they have to take an armour save. Note that they can use one or the other of these saves against a hit, not both.

8. Dangerous Terrain Test

Q: How many D6 does a war engine roll when it enters dangerous terrain?

A: One. Are units that are making counter charge moves subject to Dangerous Terrain tests?

Yes.

9. Cover to Hit Modifiers

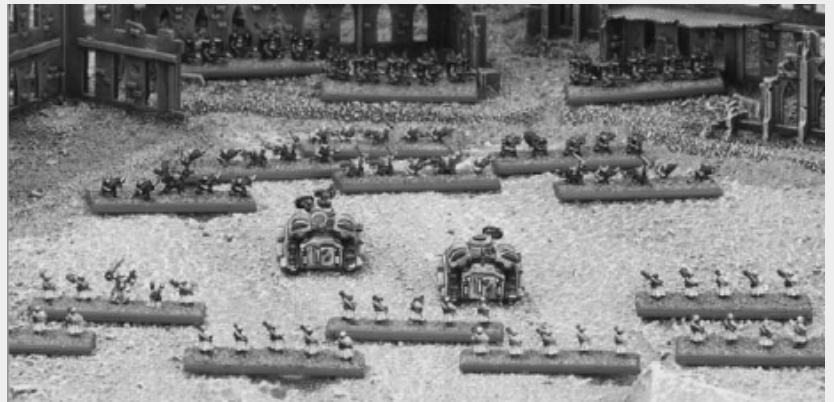
Q: When does a unit count as being in cover?

A: This should be brought up in the five minute warm up.

EXAMPLE OF PLAY*Terrain*

The Shadowsword has moved into a “hull down” position behind a low ridge. From this position it counts as being in cover against attacks from the Ork formation with the Battlefortress and Buggies attacking it from the front, and so they will suffer the -1 to hit modifier. However, the Ork Gunwagons have manoeuvred to a position where the ridge does not block their line of fire, and so they do not suffer the penalty.

An Imperial Guard infantry company is attacking an Ork warband. Some of the Ork Boyz are in cover in the buildings at the back, while some of the Ork Boyz are in the open. The Imperial player must choose if he wishes to attack only the Boyz in the open, or the whole of the Ork formation. If he chooses to attack the whole formation then he will suffer a -1 to hit modifier. In addition, the Orks in the building will benefit from the 4+ infantry cover save against any hits applied against them.



1.8.4

*Terrain Effects*¹⁰

Fortifications: Units in fortifications receive the -1 to hit modifier for being in cover and may ignore the -1 save modifier for being caught in a crossfire, though they still receive the extra blast marker (see 1.11). In addition, infantry in fortifications receive a 3+ cover save. Fortifications are normally impassable terrain for vehicles unless they are specifically designed to hold them (e.g., tank emplacements).

Hills: Units on hills will benefit from better lines of sight to enemy units, as they will be high enough to see over some terrain features (see 1.9.2, Line of Fire). This aside, units on hills count as being in open ground (or whatever other type of terrain they occupy that is also on the hill, such as roads, woods or buildings).

Open Ground: Infantry count as being in cover (-1 to hit modifier) and receive a 5+ cover save if they are on Overwatch in Open Ground. This represents the fact that stationary infantry are very hard to see. Note that the save will be lost after the infantry shoot and the Overwatch marker is removed.

Roads: Units that spend a whole move on a road may add 5cms to their move. In addition, if all of the units in a formation are on a road at the start of their action, you may declare they will make a road march. The formation takes a march action, and automatically passes the Action test. However, all of the units in the formation must remain on the road for the entire three moves.

Armoured Vehicles: Infantry count as being in cover and receive the -1 to hit modifier (but no cover save) if they are touching an armoured vehicle or war engine, to represent their ability to take cover from enemy fire by crouching behind the vehicle.

Terrain Effects Table			
<i>Terrain</i>	<i>Infantry</i>	<i>Vehicle</i>	<i>War Engine</i>
Buildings	4+ Cover Save	Impassable	Impassable
Cliffs	Impassable	Impassable	Impassable
Fortifications	3+ Cover Save, See rules	See rules	Impassable
Jungle	4+ Cover Save	Impassable	Dangerous
Marsh	6+ Cover Save, Dangerous	Dangerous	Dangerous
Open Ground, Hill Slopes	No Effect	No Effect	No Effect
River	6+ Cover Save, Dangerous	Impassable	No Effect
Roads	See rules	See rules	See rules
Ruins, Rubble	4+ Cover Save	Dangerous	Dangerous
Scrub	6+ Cover Save	No Effect	No Effect
Woods	5+ Cover Save	Dangerous	Dangerous

10. Terrain Effects

Q: How many units can claim cover from a fortification?

A: If this isn't covered by special rules or the scenario then it should be brought up in the five minute warm up.

Q: Can a speed 0cm unit on a road claim the +5cm move bonus?

A: There is no clear distinction in the rules between speed 0cm and immobile units. We recommend you go over it with your opponent during the 5 minute warm-up.

A speed 0cm unit could possibly benefit from the road movement bonus, allowing it to move 5cm per move. However, it may obviously not leave the road as it would then lose its bonus movement. A unit with a speed of "immobile" may not move, even on a road.

Q: Can units making a counter charge move on a road claim the +5cm move bonus?

A: No, the "moves" referenced here are those in actions. A counter charge move is not one of those moves.

Q: How many infantry can be counted as being in cover when touching an armoured vehicle or war engine?

A: There is no limit as per the written rules, so long as the infantry bases can touch the AV or WE. However, a limit of 2 per AV (2 per starting DC of a WE) is an extremely common house rule. Enough so that it should be brought up in the five minute warm up.

Q: Can an infantry unit claim cover from enemy armoured vehicles?

A: Yes.

1.9 SHOOTING¹¹

Many actions allow a formation to shoot. This takes place in the Action phase when the formation takes its action.

1.9.1 Picking a Target

When a player picks one formation to fire, an enemy formation is also chosen as its target. Formations may NOT split fire—any units unable to shoot at the nominated target formation lose the chance to shoot altogether.

1.9.2 Who May Shoot¹²

In order to shoot, a unit must be in range and have a line of fire to at least one unit in the target formation, and must not be suppressed.

Line Of Fire: The line of fire is a straight line drawn from the shooting unit to one unit in the target formation. The line of fire is blocked by terrain features such as buildings, hills, woods, etc. Weapons higher up can often see over any terrain that is lower down. Buildings, rubble, woods, fortifications and the like don't block the line of fire to or from units that are in the terrain itself

unless the line of fire passes through more than 10cms of the terrain feature (i.e., you can shoot 10cms “into” a terrain feature, but the line of fire is still blocked to units on the other side). The only units that can block the line of fire are war engines (see 3.0). Other units do not block the line of fire for friend or foe.

Range: In order to shoot, a unit must be in range of a unit to which it has a line of fire in the target formation.

Suppressed Units: One unit that has a line of fire and is within range may not shoot for each Blast marker on the formation. Units are suppressed “from the back to the front” of a formation, with the front and the back being determined by the location of the target formation. The units that are the furthest away from any units in the target formation are suppressed first, on the basis that troops lurking at the rear are more likely to keep their heads down than the more gung ho chaps at the front! If several units are equally far away from the target formation, then the controlling player may choose which to suppress.

11. Shooting

Q: Can you withhold fire for later in the turn?

A: No. A unit either fires when its formation activates with an action that allows it to shoot or forfeits its right to shoot.

12. Who May Shoot

Q: Can a unit being transported be suppressed?

A: Only if the transported units are allowed to shoot as per the transport unit's datasheet. Otherwise, they don't have a line of fire.

Q: Can a unit without a ranged weapon be suppressed?

A: Units with a firefight (small arms weapons) may be suppressed if they are within 15cm and have a line of fire. Units without a firefight and ranged weapons may not be suppressed.

Q: Can a unit be suppressed if it has no enemy in the fire arc of its weapons?

A: No.

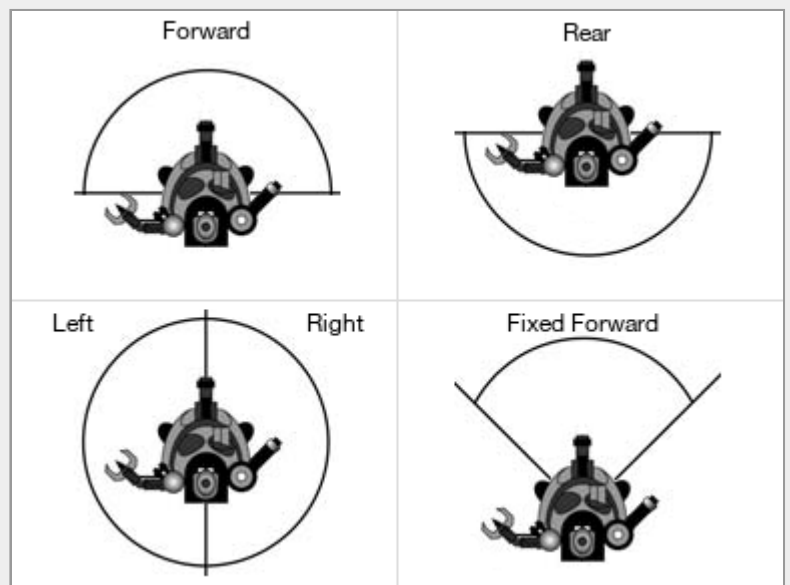
Q: When are units that are armed with a weapon that does not require a line of fire suppressed?

A: Only when they are within range of a unit from the target formation.

Weapon Fire Arcs

Most weapons can be fired in any direction (i.e., the unit does not have to be pointing at the target). However, in some cases, a weapon will be noted as having a limited weapon arc.

Weapons that are noted on the data sheet as firing to the forward have a 180° arc of fire to the unit's front, while weapons noted as firing to the rear have a 180° arc of fire to the unit's rear. Weapons with a left fire arc may fire in the 180° arc to the unit's left side, while weapons with a right fire arc can fire 180° to the unit's right. Finally, weapons that are noted as fixed forward firing can only fire on targets that lie within 45° of either side of the direction that the unit is facing.



DESIGN CONCEPT*Shooting Conventions*

The following principles apply to shooting:

Measuring Ranges: You must decide with your opponent how you will measure the range between two models during a game. The method used by the author (and the default you should use if you can't agree to an alternative) is that a weapon is in range if any bit of the attacking weapon is within range of any part of the target model (or at least one of the models on a target stand).

Lines of Fire: In Epic, the terrain and the models are assumed to be the same scale, so if you want to check a difficult line of sight between two units, all you need to do is bend over and get a “model's eye view” to see if they are in each others line of fire.

Pre-measuring: You must decide with your opponent if you are allowed to pre-measure distances during a game of Epic, or if you must declare charges or shooting attacks before measuring. For example, you must decide if you can measure to make sure a unit is within range of the enemy before deciding who it will shoot at, etc. Each method has its own distinct advantages, which boil down to pre-measuring being more precise and tactical, and not allowing pre-measuring being more characterful and exciting. If you cannot agree on which method to use then use the author's method, which is to allow pre-measuring.

1.9.3 Shooting Procedure

This is a summary of the shooting procedure. We'll work through it step-by-step in the rules that follow.

I – Place one Blast marker on the target formation.

II – Roll to hit.

III – Allocate hits, make saving throws and remove casualties.

IV – Place additional Blast markers for casualties and check to see if the enemy formation is broken.

1.9.4 Place Blast Marker¹³

The target formation automatically receives a Blast marker as long as at least one attacking unit can shoot at the formation. An additional Blast marker is received for each unit that is destroyed. A formation receives a Blast marker for coming under fire even if none of the attackers can cause any damage (e.g., armoured vehicles coming under heavy bolter fire).

13. Place Blast Marker

Q: Can a formation of units armed only with AP fire at an enemy formation of armoured vehicles to place a Blast marker on them?

A: Yes, and the same holds for the situation in reverse (AT fire on infantry).

Q: Can a formation of units armed only with Small Arms fire at an enemy formation to place a Blast marker on them?

A: No.

Q: Can units that are out of range of an enemy formation fire at them to place a Blast marker?

A: No.

1.9.5 Roll to Hit¹⁴

The player must decide at this stage whether weapons will fire with their AP or AT values if they have both. Then roll a D6 for each shot being directed at the target formation. You must roll equal to or higher than the appropriate “to hit” value to score a hit (e.g., if the weapon has an AT4+, you must roll a 4 or more to hit). The dice roll is modified for the following reasons. However a roll of 1 *before* modification is always counted as a miss.

To Hit Modifier Table

Target is in cover	-1*
Attacker is carrying out a double or marshal action	-1
Attacker is carrying out a sustained fire action	+1
<i>*The attacker can choose to ignore the cover modifier if it applies to some units in the target formation but not to others. However, you can't score hits on units in cover unless you take the -1 to hit modifier.</i>	

Needing 7+ to Hit

If to hit modifiers result in a required score of 7 or more to hit then it is still possible to score a hit, though very unlikely. As it is impossible to roll a 7 on a D6 (go on, try if you don't believe us), you will first need to roll a 6, and then, for each dice rolling a 6, you will need to roll a further score as shown on the chart below. So, for example, to roll an 8 you must roll a 6 followed by a 5 or 6.

Target	D6 rolls needed
7	6 followed by 4, 5 or 6
8	6 followed by 5 or 6
9	6 followed by 6
10	May not be hit

14. Roll To Hit

Q: Can a unit armed with two or more of the same kind of weapon choose to fire some with their AP value and others with their AT value?

A: Yes.

Q: Can a unit armed with a weapon with multiple shots choose to fire some shots with the AP value and others with the AT value?

A: No. The decision to fire with the AP or AT value is by weapon and for all of its shots.

Q: If a target formation has infantry in cover and armoured vehicles not in cover will my AT to hit rolls suffer the -1 modifier?

A: No, and the same holds for the situation in reverse (AV in cover, INF out of cover).

Q: Can I choose to fire some shots at units in cover (taking the -1 to hit modifier) and the rest at units out of cover?

A: You may not split each type of fire like this. All AP fire from a shooting formation must take the -1 modifier, or not, at the choice of the player. The same holds for AT and MW fire. However, the player could choose to take the -1 for one type of fire and not to for another.

1.9.6 Allocate Hits & Make Saving Throws¹⁵

You must allocate hits inflicted on your formation against targets that are within range and line of fire of the enemy. Hits are allocated “from the front to the back” of a formation. Note that this is the opposite of suppression. AP hits can only be allocated against infantry units, and AT hits may only be allocated against armoured vehicles. Hits must be allocated to the closest potential target first. You may not allocate a second hit to a unit until one hit has been allocated to every potential target, or allocate a third hit until all targets have been allocated two hits, etc.

Once all hits have been allocated, make saving throws for each unit that has been hit, using the unit’s armour value from its datasheet or the cover save from the terrain table. Roll a D6. If the score is lower than the armour value or cover save value then the unit fails its save, and is destroyed and removed from play. If the roll is equal to or greater than the armour or cover save value then the unit is saved and it remains in play. Make a separate save for each hit the unit suffers. Remember that the target formation receives a Blast marker for each unit that is destroyed.

If an attacking formation scores hits both with normal weapons and weapons with the macro-weapon ability, then the opposing player must allocate and make any saves for the normal hits first, and then allocate and make any saves for the macro-weapon hits. Hits from macro-weapons can only be applied to units that are in a position to be hit by a macro-weapon (Note: With the exception of War Engines (see 3.3.2), during an assault, all units up to 15cm away are valid targets for allocation, regardless of whether the hits are from CC or FF).

1.9.7 Check to See if Target Breaks

Once the attack is completely resolved, you must check to see if the target formation has been broken by the Blast markers it has received. The formation breaks if the number of Blast markers equals or exceeds the number of units in the formation. Note that formations do not break part way through a shooting attack—only once it has been resolved.

EXAMPLE OF PLAY

Shooting

A Space Marine Devastator Detachment in Rhinos has just made an advance action (to get within range of the enemy). All units have made their move, and now are permitted to shoot. They decide to shoot at an Ork warband nearby. The Space Marine player measures the range (which is within the Devastators’ range and line of fire) and places a Blast marker.

There are four Devastator units in the formation, each with two missile launchers, making for a total of eight shooting attacks. All the units in the target formation are infantry, so the Devastators elect to shoot using their AP value, which is AP5+.

The player controlling the Devastators then rolls eight dice, scoring 1, 2, 2, 4, 4, 5, 6 and 6—making for a total of 3 hits.

The nearest units in the enemy formation are all Ork Boyz stands, three of whom suffer a hit.

The Ork player then attempts to make saves for these three units, rolling one dice for each. The Ork player fails to roll any 6s, meaning that all three units are destroyed.

A further three Blast markers are placed on the warband, taking the total number of Blast markers up to four—not enough to break the warband (since it has more than four units remaining).

15. Allocate Hits & Make Saving Throws

Q: Are modifiers to an amour save cumulative? For example, does a sniper hit on a unit caught in a crossfire suffer a -2 save modifier?

A: Yes, all modifiers apply unless specifically stated otherwise.

Q: If a unit suffers save modifiers so that its armour value is effectively 7+ does it still get a save?

A: No, 7+ rolls are for hits only.

Q: How are hits allocated on a formation when it contains light vehicles as well as infantry or armoured vehicles?

A: The hits must be allocated so that none are wasted and each unit has one hit allocated to it before being allocated a second, or third, etc. if possible.

In other words, if light vehicles are with infantry then allocate AT hits to the light vehicles before AP hits. If light vehicles are with armoured vehicles then allocate AP hits to the light vehicle before AT hits. If all three types are in the same formation talk it out with your opponent.

1.9.8 *Barrages*¹⁶

Many artillery pieces, rocket launchers and some other weapons fire a barrage of shots causing mass destruction on the enemy. When these guns or launchers are grouped together in an attack they always fire a single barrage at the same target. On their datasheets, these weapons have no to hit rolls—instead they have a number of barrage points (BPs). The main difference between a barrage and a normal attack is that the barrage covers a substantial area and so may hit several units.

To fire a barrage, first take a Barrage template (see 1.0.1) and place it on the table where you want the barrage to land. Each weapon contributing to the barrage must be within range and have a line of fire to at least one unit under the template. Weapons that are not in range or do not have a line of fire to an enemy unit that falls under the template may not fire at all this turn. You are allowed to place templates over your own units, or units from several enemy formations if you wish but all units under the templates—friend and foe alike—are attacked. Any formation that is attacked receives a Blast marker for “coming under fire” (see 1.9.4). Next, refer to the data sheet to work out the total number of Barrage points. The whole formation fires at once, so the number of Barrage points for each weapon that is in range and has a line of fire is added together. When you have worked out the total number of barrage points refer to the barrage table below. Note that a formation may only fire one barrage per turn—a single formation may not fire separate barrages at different targets.

The Barrage table lists the hit roll required to hit each unit under the Barrage template. Roll to hit all units (friend or foe) under the template with the appropriate to hit values. In order to speed dice rolling we recommend rolling to hit all units of exactly the same type together, and then removing any casualties from those closest to the enemy first.

Barrage Table				
<i>Barrage Points</i>	<i>Extra Templates</i>	<i>Extra Blast Markers</i>	<i>To Hit Rolls</i>	
			<i>AP</i>	<i>AT</i>
1	None	None	6+	6+
2	None	None	5+	6+
3	None	None	4+	5+
4–5	One	None	4+	5+
6–7	One	One	4+	5+
8–9	Two	One	4+	5+
10–12	Two	Two	4+	5+
13–15	Two	Three	4+	5+
16–18	Two	Four	4+	5+

Extra Barrage Templates: Large barrages may receive extra Barrage templates. The Barrage table will tell you if a barrage receives any extra Barrage templates. Place any extra templates so that they touch the first template that was placed, and so that no templates overlap. All units under the templates are attacked with the barrage’s to hit values. Note that once the first template has been placed, the attacker may choose where to place the additional templates, as long as they are touching the first template, and no line of fire, placement or range restrictions apply (see below).

Extra Blast Markers: Really large artillery barrages are very effective at suppressing enemy troops as well as killing them. To represent this, a large barrage may inflict one, two or three extra Blast markers, as shown on the barrage table. The Blast markers are placed in addition to any Blast markers placed on a formation for it coming under fire or for any casualties that it suffered. If several formations are being attacked then each receives the appropriate number of extra Blast markers.

Using Barrage Templates: Deciding which enemy units have been caught underneath a circular Barrage template is another one of the things that can cause endless arguments during a game. The method we use (and the default you should use unless you have a different convention that you prefer) is that a unit is affected if any part of the model falls under the template, or at least one model on a stand. In addition, templates must be placed in such a way as to get as many enemy units from the target formation under them as possible within the restrictions for lines of fire and range. This stops players “sniping” at important units with artillery.

16. Barrages

Q: Can a barrage claim a crossfire bonus?

A: Yes.

Q: If a unit is under multiple templates from the same barrage how many to hit rolls are rolled for it?

A: One.

Q: Do extra Barrage templates have to be placed to get as many enemy units from the target formation under them as possible?

A: The rules are unclear here, but yes they do.

Q: Can a Barrage template be placed over units that can't be seen? Or over units that are out of range?

A: Yes, each weapon contributing to the barrage need only have a line of fire and range to a single unit under the first Barrage template. Extra Barrage templates do not require either condition, and an indirect fire barrage does not require a line of fire.

Q: Can a Barrage template be placed completely out of range?

A: Extra templates certainly can, and the first Barrage template can in certain circumstances (a unit that is partially in and partially out of range for instance). The Barrage template can be placed over any part of a unit (even if that part is out of range) so long as part of that unit is in range. A line of fire is still required to this unit, unless it is an indirect fire barrage.

Q: How do you resolve hits for a Barrage template that's over some units in cover and some that aren't?

A: Roll to hit separately for those units in cover, and for those units not in cover.

Q: How do you resolve hits for a Barrage template that's over different kinds of units?

A: Each unit under a template requires a separate to hit roll to see if it has been hit. For example, a barrage covering two Nobz (one with the Warlord), six Boyz (with two in cover), two Grotz, four Battlewagons and one Flakwagon would need to roll the following to hit rolls: one for the Nobz with the Warlord, one for the other Nobz, four for the Boyz out of cover, two for the Boyz in cover, two for the Grotz, four for the Battlewagons and one for the Flakwagon.

The "type" referred to in the sentence about speed dice rolling refers to the kind of unit (Tactical, Assault, Devastator, etc.) not the unit type (INF, AV, etc.).

Q: How are barrages where some barrage points have special abilities resolved?

A: When firing in a barrage, a special weapon ability can only be used if all of the units firing have it. If a special ability is used in a barrage then those barrage weapons that don't have the special ability may not fire in the barrage, nor may they fire a separate barrage during their activation.

1.10 OVERWATCH¹⁷

A formation that takes an overwatch action may not move, but may shoot, outside of the normal turn sequence, in response to an enemy formation's movement. We mark formations on overwatch using the Games Workshop Order dice, but you can use other methods if you prefer. Note that if a formation has units more than 5cm from another unit in the formation (i.e., it is not in a legal formation), then the formation may **not** take an overwatch action, as it **must** move back into a legal formation if it can.

A formation that is on overwatch may choose to shoot immediately after an enemy formation completes a move or unloads troops, and before the target either shoots or assaults.

Note that a formation on overwatch is allowed to shoot at an enemy formation after any move, so it may shoot at a formation making several moves after it has completed one of these moves and before it carries out the next one. This stops fast formations

using double or march actions to “whiz past” a formation that is on overwatch.

Also note that formations on overwatch may only react when a formation moves or unloads troops. They may not choose to shoot at a formation that does anything else in their line of fire, such as shooting without moving or regrouping.

Resolve the shooting attacks using the normal rules. The overwatching formation must shoot at the formation that triggered the shooting—it can't pick a different target. Once it has fired, the formation is no longer considered to be on overwatch.

Formations remain on overwatch until they either shoot, or they undertake a new action in the following turn. Note that this means that a unit can go into overwatch on one turn, and not shoot until the following turn. Shooting in the following turn counts as your action for that turn, and will stop the formation taking an action later on. If the formation does not shoot in the following turn then it may take an action instead of shooting.

17. Overwatch

Q: Can a formation on overwatch use its overwatch fire when it is not a legal formation?

A: Yes, the requirement to be a legal formation is only when the formation is taking an overwatch action. However, it could not choose to remain on overwatch as it would have to move back into a legal formation.

Q: Can a formation on overwatch use its overwatch fire when it is in the zone of control of an enemy formation.

A: Yes, as it is not taking an action when shooting while on overwatch. However, it could not choose to remain on overwatch as it would have to charge the enemy or leave its zone of control.

Q: A formation carries out an action that involves a move but none of the units physically move, is it still susceptible to overwatch?

A: Yes. Any action that includes one of more moves (advance, engage, double, march and possibly marshal, hold and special actions) is considered a move for the purposes of overwatch, even if units moved 0cm.
Note that withdrawals and consolidation moves are optional however, and that a player can choose not to move the formation at all, thus avoiding overwatch.

Q: Do units that enter play via a special rule (landing, planetfall, self planetfall, teleporting, tunneling, being summoned or swarmed) trigger overwatch fire?

A: No, only completing a move or disembarking triggers overwatch.

Q: An air assault suffers overwatch fire when a transported formation disembarks. Which formation receives the Blast marker for coming under fire?

A: The disembarking formation, as it triggered the overwatch.

Q: A commander orders a second formation to follow their formation in an assault, they count as a single formation when making an engage move and take overwatch fire. Which formation receives the Blast marker for coming under fire?

A: The formation that was closest to the enemy overwatching formation.

Q: Does a counter charge move trigger overwatch fire?

A: No.

Q: What happens to formation that is broken from overwatch fire while it is carrying out an action?

A: See 1.13.3, “it makes a withdrawal and loses the rest of its action.”

Q: Do formations on overwatch need to take an Action test to remain on overwatch?

A: Yes. However, if all the unactivated formations you have left are on overwatch you can declare they are all remaining on overwatch without an Action test (even if they are not a legal formation, in enemy zone of control, have Blast markers, etc.), effectively ending your part in the Action phase.

EXAMPLE OF PLAY

Overwatch

As his first action for the turn, the Imperial Guard player chooses to try to put one of his Steel Legion Mechanized Infantry Companies onto overwatch. He passes the Action test and the unit goes onto overwatch.

Nearby, an Ork formation chooses a sustained fire action and shoots at a nearby Titan. The Ork formation doesn't move, so can't trigger the formation on overwatch to fire. Their overwatch goes on...

Later in the same turn, another Ork formation chooses a double action and moves across in front of the Imperial Guard on overwatch. At the end of their first move, the Orks are within line of fire of the Imperial Guard detachment, but the player decides not to shoot at them since their second move will take them closer to another unit with which he can shoot them anyway. The overwatch is not triggered and still goes on...

A new turn begins and the Ork player wins the Strategy phase, enabling him to go first. The first thing the Ork player does is begin an engage action with a Kult of Speed, which begins tearing towards the Imperial Guard. At the end of their move, they are very close to the Imperial Guard formation, but before the assault is resolved, the Imperial Guard player announces that he is going to trigger the formation's overwatch and shoot at the Kult of Speed. The shooting is resolved normally, and in all likelihood will provide a massive aid to the Imperial Guard in the coming assault.

After the effects of the shooting have been resolved, the assault is resolved normally.

1.11 CROSSFIRE¹⁸

“Ere we go, ’ere we go, ’ere we go... Bloody hell, where’d dose beaky wagonz come from? Quick! Ladz, face dis way. No, no, no! Not dat way, dis way. Oi! Where are yoos boyz running off too? Come back ’ere ya yoosless lot... Bugga! Oh well, I guess I’ll just have to take out dem wagonz meself. ’Ere we go den... WAAAAAARGH!!!”

Last words of Warlord Naz-bakk

Formations that take fire from the flank or rear are caught in a deadly crossfire, and will suffer additional casualties as troops struggle to find cover from attacks coming from an unexpected direction.

To represent this, formations are allowed to use the following rules to claim a crossfire bonus when they shoot. You can claim the crossfire bonus if you can draw a straight line up to 45cm long from any of the units in the shooting formation to any unit in another friendly formation *and* this line crosses a unit from the target formation *or* the gap between two units from the target formation.

The friendly unit that the crossfire line is drawn to must have a line of fire to a unit from the target formation, but does not have to be in range with any of its weapons. You may not use units that are in broken or marching formations to claim the crossfire bonus.

All units from a formation caught in a crossfire suffer a -1 save modifier. This may result in some units automatically failing their saving throw. Some terrain features or special rules may counter this modifier (see 1.8.4 and 2.1.16).

In addition, a formation caught in a crossfire attack receives two Blast markers for the **first** unit destroyed by the attack, rather than just one Blast marker for the destroyed unit as would usually be the case (see 1.9.4).

Note that a formation attacked by several enemy formations, each of which can claim a crossfire, will receive the extra Blast marker from *each* enemy formation that inflicts one or more casualties.

18. Crossfire

Q: Does the friendly unit need to shoot at the same target formation in order to be used to catch it in a crossfire?

A: No.

Q: Does the friendly unit need to have a weapon that can affect the target formation in order to be used to catch it in a crossfire?

A: No, it doesn’t need weapons at all or even a Firefight value.

Q: Does the shooting formation need to have a line of fire to the friendly unit?

A: No, both the shooting formation and the friendly unit only need a line of fire to the target formation.

Q: Does the -1 save modifier apply to cover saves?

A: Yes.

EXAMPLE OF PLAY*Crossfire*

The Land Raiders have taken an advance action and moved to the position shown in the photograph below. The Space Marine player is able to draw a line of fire less than 45cms long to a unit in the Space Marine Tactical formation, and so is able to claim the crossfire bonus when shooting on the Orks.

The Land Raiders' lascannon are ineffective against the Ork infantry, but their heavy bolters inflict three hits. The -1 save modifier means that it is impossible for the Orks to make their armour save so three units are removed as casualties.

Five Blast markers are inflicted on the Orks: one for coming under fire, two for the first casualty caused by the heavy bolter fire, and two more for the remaining two casualties. There are only five units left in the Ork warband, so the five Blast markers inflicted by the Land Raiders are just enough to break the warband.

1.12 ASSAULTS¹⁹

Formations that carry out an engage action are allowed to move and then fight an assault. An assault represents a situation where all hell breaks loose as troops desperately try to seize a vital objective, or fight a tenacious defence to keep the objective in friendly hands. Assaults are not necessarily face to face or toe to toe, simply close enough that individual infantry are able to engage in the fight and make use of their small arms, grenades and other short ranged weapons. Casualties will often be high on both sides, and at the end of the assault, one side or the other will be forced to withdraw with its morale shattered, leaving the field to the victor.

DESIGN CONCEPT

Assaults

The rules for assaults that follow are a crucial part of the Epic rules, and so it's important to understand what they represent. Unlike most wargames, where assaults only really cover hand-to-hand combat, in Epic an assault covers everything that happens when a formation is ordered to assault an enemy formation. To put this another way, if you think of an assault as covering everything that happens in a typical 4–6 turn game of Warhammer 40,000, then you won't go too far wrong!

This means that while hand-to-hand combat (called close combat in Epic) can be a part of what happens in an assault, it is by no means everything that happens. You will find it quite common for assaults to be resolved without any units making it into close combat at all, just as games of Warhammer 40,000 can be resolved without any close combat taking place.

One final point that needs to be made here is that an assault only occurs if a formation takes an engage action. This means it is possible for enemy formations to end up very close to each other (less than 15cms) without having to fight an assault. This reflects your troops' natural inclination to get under cover when they are close to the enemy unless they are ordered to attack.

1.12.1 Assault Procedure

This is a summary of the assault procedure. We'll work through it step by step in the rules that follow:

- I** – Choose target formation
- II** – Make charge move
- III** – Make counter-charges
- IV** – Resolve attacks
- V** – Work out result
- VI** – Loser withdraws
- VII** – Winner consolidates

1.12.2 Choose Target Formation

A formation taking an engage action must pick an enemy formation as the target of the assault. Any enemy formation may be chosen anywhere on the table, though for reasons that will become apparent it makes sense to choose someone fairly close by.

Under certain circumstances, a formation may assault two or more enemy formations (see the special rule for intermingled formations).

1.12.3 Make Charge Move²⁰

A formation undertaking an engage action is allowed to make **one** move (not a double distance move as is the case in many sets of wargame rules, not least many Games Workshop games), and then fights an assault against the enemy formation that was chosen as the target of the charge. This move is known as the *charge move*.

Make the move normally, as described in the movement rules given previously. Once the move is complete, the engaging

20. Make Charge Move

- Q: Can a unit that's making a charge move put an enemy unit in base contact if the enemy is in terrain that is dangerous to the charging unit?
- A: Yes, if part of the enemy unit is not in dangerous terrain the unit can be put in base contact there without taking a dangerous terrain test. If the enemy unit is completely within the dangerous terrain then the charging unit would have to take a dangerous terrain test.
- Q: Can a unit that's making a charge move put an enemy unit in base contact if the enemy is in terrain that is impassable to the charging unit?
- A: Yes, if part of the enemy unit is not in impassable terrain the unit can be put in base contact there. If the enemy unit is completely within the impassable terrain then no.
- Q: What happens to a charging unit that enters the zone of control of an enemy unit and it does not have enough movement to make it into base contact?
- A: The charging unit would move as much as possible towards the closest enemy unit. The intent of the rule is that you should not be able to charge through a zone of control to reach a unit further away but should always move towards the closest enemy unit even if you cannot make it into base contact.
- Q: Can a unit making a charge move claim the cover to hit modifier and receive a cover save against overwatch fire?
- A: Yes and yes.
- Q: After it makes a charge move does the engaging formation need to have at least one unit with a line of fire to a unit in the target formation in order for the assault to take place?
- A: Yes. While it is not specifically stated in the rules it is implied ("close enough that individual infantry are able to engage in the fight and make use of their small arms") and required to resolve firefight attacks.

¹⁹. Assaults

Q: Do assaults occur when neither player takes an engage action?

A: No, they never automatically occur.

formation must have at least one unit within 15cms of a unit from the target formation. If this is not the case then the assault does not take place and the action ends. This caveat aside, units from the charging formation may move in any direction and do not have to head towards the enemy.

Units making a charge move are allowed to enter enemy zones of control in order to move into base contact with an enemy unit from the target formation. Moving into base contact allows the unit to fight with its close combat value rather than its firefight value, as described below. This is the only time a unit may enter an enemy zone of control. See the rules for zones of control (1.7.3). Note that charging units may not enter the zone of control of enemy units from another formation that is not the target of the assault.

A maximum of two units may move into base contact with each defender. A charging unit that enters a zone of control must move into base contact with the nearest enemy whose zone of control has been entered. Once a unit has been contacted it loses its zone of control for the rest of the assault, allowing other units to move past it.

It's important to note that all you have to do is get one unit within 15cms of the enemy chosen as the target of the assault. There is no need for any units to get into base-to-base contact with the enemy unless you want them to.

1.12.4 Counter Charges²¹

An assault represents a brutal short-range battle involving movement, shooting and close combat. Although the assaulting

formation will have initiated the combat, the defending formation will have time to react to the enemy assault and make limited moves of their own. To represent this, units from the defending formation involved in the assault are allowed to make a special move called a *counter charge*.

Defending units that are not already in base contact with an enemy unit are allowed to counter charge. Units with a speed of 30cm or more may make a counter charge move of 10cm. Units with a speed of 25cm or less may make a counter charge move of 5cm. Counter charges happen after the engaging formation has finished moving and any overwatch shots have been taken, but before the combat is resolved. All the normal charge move rules apply, and defending formations must still be in a legal formation after the counter charge moves have been made (i.e., all units must be within 5cm of another unit from their formation). Embarked units may dismount.

A unit must use their counter charge move to move directly towards the closest enemy unit. It may move into base contact if close enough, and as long as the enemy is not already in contact with two defending units. Units can choose not to counter charge if they wish, but if they do counter charge they must head towards the nearest enemy.

Counter charging units are allowed to counter charge enemy units from any enemy formation, not just the one they were assaulted by. Any enemy formations that are contacted by counter charging units are drawn into the assault, and will fight just as if they had made the assault themselves. Treat them and the original attacking formation as a single formation for all rules purposes for the duration of the assault.

A 2D6 roll is used to resolve a combined assault. If the attacker loses then each formation is broken. If the attacker wins then each formation receives a number of Blast markers equal to the number of units the formation lost in the assault.

1.12.5 Resolve Attacks²²

All units have two assault values: a *close combat* value and a *firefight*

21. Counter Charges

Q: When a unit uses its counter-charge is it towards the closest enemy unit in the attacking formation or just the closest enemy unit?

A: The closest enemy unit. This could be a unit from another formation.

Q: If the closest enemy unit is in contact with two defending units can a unit counter-charge the next closest instead?

A: Yes.

Q: What happens when the closest enemy unit cannot be reached due to impassable terrain or friendly units?

A: The counter-charge would follow the shortest path to get to the closest enemy unit.

Q: Can units counter-charge over friendly units?

A: Follow the normal movement rules (see 1.7.2) with respect to this.

Q: Can units disembark from a unit that has already counter-charged?

A: Yes, so long as the transport unit isn't in base contact with two enemy units.

Q: Can a unit that disembarked other units still counter-charge?

A: No, disembarking happens at the end of a move.

Q: Can a formation that used its overwatch fire on the attacking formation still counter-charge?

A: Yes.

Q: After counter charges are made does the engaging formation need to have at least one unit with a line of fire to a unit in the target formation in order for the assault to take place?

A: In the first round yes, as "all the normal charge move rules apply". In subsequent rounds the assault is already taking place and its result must be determined.

Q: What happens when an assault goes into a second round and no units are within 15cm of each other after both sides counter charge?

A: Work out the result again.

22. Resolve Attacks

Q: Do cover to hit modifiers apply in an assault?

A: No.

Q: Can a hit be allocated to a unit that does not have a line of fire to an enemy unit?

A: No, these hits are allocated in the same manner as shooting hits: they require a line of fire.

Q: How are attacks with special abilities like ignore cover and lance allocated in an assault?

A: This was never covered in the rules. The unofficial consensus is that they should be allocated in such a way to utilize their special rules, if possible. I.e., ignore cover hits should be allocated to units that are benefiting from a cover save and lance hits should be allocated to units with reinforced armour. This is something you should bring up with your opponent in the five minute warm up.

Q: Can a cover save be used in an assault?

A: The defender can use them, but not the attacker.

Q: Can the crossfire bonus be used in an assault?

A: No.

Q: Does an attacking unit need to have a line of fire to a unit in the target formation in order to be considered "directly engaged"?

A: Yes.

value. Units that are in base-to-base contact with the enemy use the close combat value, while units that are not in base contact but are within 15cm and have a line of fire to the enemy can use their firefight value. Units that are armed only with close combat weapons and do not have any small arms or other ranged weapons may only attack if in base contact with the enemy.

Roll 1D6 for each unit that may attack. Note that Blast markers do not suppress units from formations involved in an assault—it is assumed that the proximity of the enemy means that everyone joins in! Compare the dice roll to the unit's close combat value if it's in contact with the enemy, or its firefight value if it's within 15cm of the enemy but not in base contact. If the dice roll is equal to or greater than the relevant value, then a hit is scored on the enemy. No modifiers ever apply to these dice rolls.

Each player allocates the hits and make saving throws in the same manner as they would when allocating hits from shooting. Hits may only be allocated to units that were directly engaged in the combat (i.e., that belonged to the attacking or defending formation and which were within 15cms of the enemy after charge and counter-charge moves were completed). Infantry units from formations taking a charge action may not take cover saves (they are assumed to have left cover to charge the enemy), but other infantry units may take cover saves normally.

If all of the units in the defending formation have been killed and at least one attacker survives, then the attacker wins and the assault is over (go straight to 1.12.8). If all of the attacking units directly engaged in the assault are killed then the assault has stalled and the defender wins (go straight to 1.12.8). “Directly engaged” means being within 15cm of a defending unit after charge and counter-charge moves have been completed. If even one of the original attackers that were within 15cms of the enemy survives, then the attack has not stalled. In any other case, both sides can call on support (see 1.12.6).

Important Note: Kills inflicted in an assault do not count for placing blast markers or for breaking a formation until **after** the result of the combat has been worked out. Also note that the attacker must completely destroy the defending formation to win at this stage, while all the defender has to do is to kill all the attacking units that made it to within 15cms of a defender.

DESIGN CONCEPT

Assault Weapons and Small Arms

Many unit datasheets include weapons that are noted as being either assault weapons or small arms.

The term assault weapons covers all of the diverse close combat weapons of the 41st Millennium, including chainswords, power weapons and Ork choppas. The effect of these weapons is included in a unit's Close Combat value and so they can only be used during an assault. For example, Assault Marines with chainswords have the effect of these weapons included in their Close Combat value of 3+.

The term “small arms” covers a dizzying array of short-range weapons used by units in the 41st Millennium. Examples include lasguns, bolters and Ork shootas. The effect of these weapons is included in a unit's Firefight value and can only be used during an assault. For example, Tactical Marines with boltguns have the effect of these weapons included in their Firefight value of 4+.

An assault is the only time that units get to use their “small arms” such as bolters or lasguns, although these weapons have a nominal range of 15cm on the unit datasheets. This represents the limited amounts of ammo carried for such weapons, and also that in combat most soldiers will keep their heads down and only shoot when the situation is really desperate! Neither of these problems generally apply to heavy weapons teams, which is why these weapons get to shoot all of the time.

1.12.6 Supporting Fire²³

Both sides may call upon support unless the defender has been wiped out or the attack stalled as described above. Calling on support allows units from other formations to attack with their firefight value if they are within 15cm and have a line of fire to an enemy unit directly involved in the assault. In this case “directly involved” means belonging to the attacking or defending formation(s) and in a position to attack. This rule represents units from both sides that are not directly involved in the assault lending supporting fire when they see their friends coming under attack. Units from formations that are either Broken or Marched this turn cannot lend support.

Roll to hit using the firefight values of the supporting formations, and then allocate hits and make saving throws as you would do for shooting attacks. Once all casualties have been removed you must work out the result of the attack (see 1.12.7).

1.12.7 Work Out Result²⁴

After both players have removed casualties, the outcome of the combat must be decided.

First, if one side completely wiped the other side out, then it is the winner. If this isn't the case then each player rolls 2D6, and adds any modifiers that apply from the chart below to the single D6 that rolled highest. Note that you don't add your dice rolls together, but use the single dice with the highest score. Whoever has the higher score after any modifiers have been added wins the assault.

In addition, the losing formation suffers a number of extra hits equal to the difference between the two sides' result scores. There are no saves for these hits, which represent units being hacked down as they turn and run, or disintegrating into a panic-driven rout as they flee. Remove these additional casualties as you would hits inflicted in the assault phase (i.e., units in base contact first, then those closest to the enemy, etc.).

In the case of a tied dice roll fight a second assault using any surviving units, starting with step 4 (i.e. roll dice, allocate hits, make saves and resolve the combat all over again with any survivors). Units from both sides are allowed to make a counter charge move before the second round is fought, with the attacker moving his counter charging units first (see 1.12.4). If a second round is fought then any casualties from the first round carry over when working out the result of the combat.

23. Supporting Fire

Q: Is supporting fire affected by suppression?

A: No.

Q: What does “directly involved” mean here?

A: In order to support with their firefight a unit must have a line of fire to at least one enemy unit that attacked with its close combat or firefight during the assault.

Q: Can hits from supporting fire carry over on to units that weren't “directly involved”?

A: No.

Q: How is “directly involved” evaluated in assaults that go on for multiple rounds?

A: Check and re-evaluate at the end of every round. In a three round assault a unit can go from directly involved, to not, and back again with counter-charges and units being removed.

24. Work Out Result

Q: Are the extra hits the losing formation suffers only applied to units that were “directly involved”?

A: No, they are applied to any units in the losing formation.

Q: Do the extra hits the losing formation suffers require a line of fire?

A: No.

Q: Can the extra hits the losing formation suffers be allocated to units being transported in a fearless transport?

A: Yes.

Q: How are the extra hits the losing formation suffers allocated to a formation with units being transported?

A: Once one of these hits is allocated to a transport (or it is skipped over because it is fearless) all units it is transporting must be allocated a hit (while any remain) before moving on to the next closest unit. Any remaining units that were being transported (fearless units, or those that weren't allocated a hit) would then make their normal armour save or a 6+ cover save if the transport was destroyed, the formation would not receive a Blast marker for any of these saves if they failed.

Q: Are units lost due to overwatch fire on the attacking formation counted when working out the result?

A: No.

Q: Are units lost due to failed dangerous terrain tests counted when working out the result?

A: No, they are not kills you have inflicted.

1.12.8 Loser Withdraws

After the result of the combat has been worked out (either because all defending units were destroyed, or the attack stalled, or through a result roll), then the loser is broken and must withdraw, and formations on the winning side receive Blast markers for the casualties they suffered.

If the loser was already broken when it was assaulted then the whole formation is destroyed, and ALL units in the formation are removed from play as casualties. If the losing formation is not broken then it becomes broken and may withdraw (see 1.13.3).

Once any additional casualties have been removed, any surviving units on the losing side must make an immediate withdrawal as explained in the rules for broken formations later on (see 1.13.3).

Finally, any formations belonging to the losing side that were in a position to have lent support (i.e., they were within 15cms of an enemy unit in the assault) receive one Blast marker each, even if they did not actually lend support. These Blast markers represent the detrimental effect on morale of seeing friends defeated in an assault.

1.12.9 Winner Consolidates ²⁵

After the loser has withdrawn, the winning formation receives a number of Blast markers equal to the number of units that were killed by the enemy. Note that it is possible for a formation to win an assault and then become broken by the casualties that they suffered! In this case, the winning formation is broken, but does not have to make a withdrawal even if other enemy units are within 15cm (see 1.13.3). If the winner of the combat was already broken at the start of the combat, they do not receive any additional Blast markers.

Any units on the winning side may then move 5cm. This is a free bonus move designed to allow attacking units to occupy territory they have captured. Units may not enter an enemy's zone of control when they consolidate.

25. Winner Consolidates

Q: Can a transport unit pick up another unit as part of its consolidation move? What if the unit being picked up disembarked at the end of the charge move?

A: Yes and yes, but the unit being picked up may not make a consolidation move when this happens (see 1.7.5).

Q: Do I have to use a consolidation move to move out of an enemy's zone of control?

A: No. A consolidation move isn't mandatory, it just can't be used to enter another enemy unit's zone of control.

Note that this can create the situation where a fearless unit does not withdraw and units from the winning side remain in base contact with it. When this happens the opposing formation will automatically be drawn in to an assault on either formation.

Assault Modifiers	(Cumulative)
For each kill you have inflicted during the assault	+1
You have more units than the opposing formation	+1*
You have more than twice as many units as the opposing formation	+1*
Your formation has no Blast markers	+1**
The opposing formation has more Blast markers	+1**
* Count the total number of units remaining in the charging formation against the total number of units remaining in the defending formation. Don't include units from other formations that were lending supporting fire.	
** Count broken enemy formations as having as many Blast markers as units.	

1.12.10***Intermingled Formations***²⁶

Occasionally an attacker will wish to attack a position where units from two enemy formations are intermingled together. When a player declares the target for a charging formation he can choose, if he wishes, to include any enemy formations that are intermingled with the target formation as being part of the target of the charge. Two formations are intermingled if they have any units within 5cm of each other. If there are two or more formations within 5cm of the target formation, then the attacker can choose to include one or more of them as the target, he does not though have to include any of them.

For the purposes of the assault, the intermingled formation is treated as being a single formation. All of the intermingled formations are allowed to make counter charges, and hits may be allocated to all of the formations involved. Once casualties have been worked out, a 2D6 roll is used to resolve the assault. Add together all of the Blast markers on the intermingled formations when working out the result of the assault. If the defender loses then each formation is broken and must withdraw. If the defender wins then each formation receives a number of Blast markers equal to the number of casualties it suffered in the combat (i.e., if one defending formation lost two units and then another one, then the first would get two Blast markers and the other would receive one Blast marker).

26. Intermingled Formations

Q: If a formation is intermingled with a broken formation, can the extra hits from losing the assault be taken on the broken formation?

A: Yes, so long as those units are closer to the attacking formation. Units are removed for those extra hits and then broken formations are destroyed.

Q: Does the charging formation need to get within 15cm of all intermingled formations?

A: No.

Q: Does the charging formation need to get within 15cm of the original target or can it get within 15cm of any intermingled formation?

A: Talk about it with your opponent during the five minute up, it's played both ways around the world.

1.13 REGROUPING & BROKEN FORMATIONS

Formations that take a marshal action are allowed to regroup in order to remove Blast markers and attempt to avoid becoming broken. Formations are broken once they have received a number of Blast markers equal to the number of units in the formation, or if they lose an assault. Broken formations may not be selected to take an action in the Action phase.

1.13.1 Regrouping

Formations that take a marshal action may regroup. Roll 2D6 and remove a number of Blast markers equal to the highest roll. Note that the dice are not added together; instead the score of the higher dice is used.

1.13.2 Becoming Broken²⁷

Check to see if a formation is broken after it receives any Blast markers (either from failing an Action test, shooting or winning an assault). Formations that lose an assault are automatically broken. You should completely resolve an assault or an attacking formation's shooting before checking to see if the target formation breaks (i.e., don't break a formation that comes under fire until all of the shooting has been resolved).

Remove all of the Blast markers from a formation when it breaks, and mark it in some way to show that it is broken. You can mark a broken formation in any manner you like; some players simply remember, others turn units in a broken detachment away from the enemy, or you can use the Order Dice or Battle Markers produced by Games Workshop. At the end of the day, as long as you remember which formations are broken and which are not then any method will do.

1.13.3 Withdrawals

Unless the rules state specifically otherwise, a broken formation may choose to make a withdrawal immediately after the action that caused it to break has been resolved. If a formation is broken part way through an action that it is taking (i.e., by the Blast marker received for failing an initiative test, or as a result of Blast markers received from overwatch fire), then it makes a withdrawal and loses the rest of its action.

A formation making a withdrawal may make two moves. Withdrawal moves may be made in any direction, but if a unit ends the second withdrawal move within 15cm of the enemy, it is destroyed (it is killed while trying to escape!). Units may ignore enemy zones of control while making a withdrawal move but may not move directly over enemy units. These changes aside, withdrawal moves are treated exactly like a normal move. Enemy formations on overwatch can shoot at formations making withdrawal moves.

Units with a speed of 0cm obviously cannot move when making a withdrawal, so are destroyed if there are any enemy units within 15cm at the point they become broken.

1.13.4 Blast Markers and Broken Formations²⁸

Broken formations count as having as many Blast markers as units for any rules purposes.

Broken formations do not receive Blast markers after they have been broken and before they rally. Instead each Blast marker that the formation would normally receive causes an additional hit on the formation, with no saving throw allowed. Apply these extra hits as you would from normal shooting (i.e., from front to back of the formation). These additional hits represent individual units panicking and fleeing the battlefield, and they make broken formations extremely vulnerable to enemy attack—you have been warned!

Remember that a broken formation that wins an assault does not receive any Blast markers for the casualties it suffered, and will not therefore lose any additional units due to panic. It is assumed that in this case, the feeling of triumph at winning the assault overcomes any feelings of terror or fear.

27. Becoming Broken

Q: Does a broken unit have a zone of control?

A: Yes.

28. Blast Markers and Broken Formations

Q: Do the units removed from the additional hits cause Blast markers.

A: No.

1.14 THE END PHASE²⁹

The End phase takes place, unsurprisingly, at the end of the turn, once both players have taken an action with each of their unbroken formations. Both players *must* attempt to rally any formations and then check the scenario victory conditions to see if either side has won.

1.14.1 Rallying Formations³⁰

In the End phase both players take turns to rally formations that have Blast markers or that are broken. Rally the formations one at a time, starting with the player with the higher strategy rating. In order to rally a formation you must roll equal to or over the formation's initiative value on a D6 (see 1.2.2). There is a -2 modifier to the dice roll if the formation is broken, and a -1 modifier if enemy units are within 30cm of a unit from the formation.

If the test is failed, then broken formations must make a withdrawal (see 1.13.3), while formations that are unbroken must remain in place but may not remove any Blast markers.

If the test is passed then remove half the Blast markers from the formation, rounding fractions up. Formations with one Blast marker remaining that pass a Rally test remove the last Blast marker. A broken formation that rallies is no longer broken. It counts as having as many Blast markers as units, half of which will be removed for passing the Rally test. For example, a broken formation with seven units that rallied would no longer be broken and would receive three Blast markers.

Rally Test Modifiers

Formation is broken	-2
There are enemy units within 30cms	-1

Modifiers are cumulative.

1.14.2 Check Victory Conditions

Most games of Epic are played using a scenario that will have a set of victory conditions that a player needs to achieve in order to win. See the special rules for scenarios in the special rules section for more details on how this works.

Rounding

In Epic, all fractions are rounded up unless the rules specifically say otherwise. Generosity rules where 6mm soldiers are concerned!

29. The End Phase

Q: What is the order of events that happen in the End Phase?

A: If alternating, the player with the higher strategy rating chooses who will go first.

1. Aircraft make disengagement moves (simultaneous)
2. Resolve critical hit and other “end of turn” effects (alternate)
3. Rally (alternate)
4. Remove daemons (simultaneous)
5. Check victory conditions (depends on scenario)

30. Rallying Formations

Q: Can a broken formation activate in the turn after it failed to rally?

A: No, it can only attempt to rally in each End phase.

Q: Can a broken formation that failed to rally make a withdrawal move in the End phase if it already made a withdrawal in the Action phase when it broke?

A: Yes.

Q: Can formations that are off-board rally?

A: Yes, unless a special rule states otherwise, and they are not considered to be within 30cm of enemy units.

1.15 CORE RULES TRAINING SCENARIOS

“Only faith in the Emperor and the training I am going to give you will save you on the battlefield.”

Veteran Sergeant Kesser

You have now read all you need to know in order to try out the following training scenarios. A scenario is basically a set of notes, telling you all you need to know about the battle you are going to fight. It will tell you what forces are involved, what vehicles each player has, what each side's objectives are, and so on.

In order to play the core rules training scenarios you will need to get hold of a couple of dozen units of Epic scale Space Marines. It will help if you can track down some Predator Destructors and Rhinos too, but these are not vital. There is a free downloadable file on the NetEA website which has a set of counters for the Space Marine units and vehicles used in the scenarios, so if you have access to the internet you can try out the first two scenarios even if you don't have the correct models. Datasheets for the units can be found in the Forces section (see 5.0).

In order to play the scenarios that follow, you will also need a small amount of gaming terrain. You can use Warhammer or Warhammer 40,000 hills and trees if you don't have any in Epic scale, or just lay a cloth over some books to create rolling, hilly terrain.

Note: The datasheets for these five scenarios are in Section 5.0.

1.15.1 Basic Training Scenario

Even Space Marines need to practise their tactics and strategy. This basic training scenario is based on one of these exercises and pits Space Marines from the same Chapter against each other in a simple training exercise. The object is to take and hold an objective.

Force Alpha: Two formations each with six Space Marine Tactical units. The force has a strategy rating of 5 and all formations have an initiative value of 1+.

Force Beta: Two formations each with six Space Marine Tactical units. The force has a strategy rating of 5 and all formations have an initiative value of 1+.

Gaming Area: Set up a playing area approximately 60–90cm square. Set up any scenery you have in a mutually agreeable manner. You can set up as much or as little scenery as you like, but try to make sure that you have at least a couple of hills and either a built-up area or some woods for the troops to hide behind or take cover in. Place an “objective counter” in the very centre of the battlefield (a coin will do just fine).

Deployment: If one player set up the scenery then his opponent can choose which table edge to deploy on. If you set up the scenery together then roll dice to see who gets the choice of edge. The other player sets up on the opposite table edge. You must deploy all of your units within 15cms of your table edge.

Special Rules: All Space Marine units may use the *They Shall Know No Fear* special rule (see *They Shall Know No Fear*).

Victory Conditions: You capture the objective if you have a unit within 15cms of it in the end phase and your opponent does

not. To win the game, you must capture the objective and hold it for one full game turn.

1.15.2 Fast Attack Training Scenario

Space Marine armies are highly mobile and make great use of armoured transport vehicles to strike at the enemy with lightning speed. By far the most common Space Marine transport vehicle is the ubiquitous Rhino, a sturdy and reliable machine capable of transporting ten fully equipped Space Marines across the battlefield.

Force Alpha: Two formations each with six Space Marine Tactical units and three Rhinos. The force has a strategy rating of 5 and all formations have an initiative value of 1+.

Force Beta: Two formations each with six Space Marine Tactical units and three Rhinos. The force has a strategy rating of 5 and all formations have an initiative value of 1+.

Gaming Area: Same as Basic Training (see 1.15.1).

Deployment: Same as Basic Training (see 1.15.1).

Victory Conditions: Same as Basic Training (see 1.15.1).

Special Rules: Same as Basic Training (see 1.15.1).

1.15.3 Armoured Training Scenario

Space Marines make use of a number of different types of armoured fighting vehicle. Among the most common is the Predator Destructor, a nicely balanced fighting machine with weapons suitable for engaging both armoured and vehicle targets. This scenario is based on the training exercises used to teach Space Marines the skills required to work as a member of the crew of a Predator tank.

Force Alpha: Two formations each with four Space Marine Predator Destructors. The force has a strategy rating of 5 and all formations have an initiative value of 1+.

Force Beta: Two formations each with four Space Marine Predator Destructors. The force has a strategy rating of 5 and all formations have an initiative value of 1+.

Gaming Area: Same as Basic Training (see 1.15.1).

Deployment: Same as Basic Training (see 1.15.1).

Victory Conditions: Same as Basic Training (see 1.15.1).

Special Rules: Same as Basic Training (see 1.15.1).

1.15.4 Advanced Training Scenario

Space Marine armies include a number of specialised formations and troop types such as Space Marine Assault units equipped with Jump Packs, and Space Marine Devestators equipped with additional heavy weapons. This scenario is based on the advanced training missions used by the Space Marines to show how the presence of these units affects the tactics learned during basic training.

Force Alpha: Two formations each with six Space Marine tactical units and three Rhinos, plus one formation of four Space Marine Assault units. The force has a strategy rating of 5 and all formations have an initiative value of 1+.

Force Beta: Two formations each with six Space Marine tactical

units and three Rhinos, plus one formation of four Space Marine Devastators. The force has a strategy rating of 5 and all formations have an initiative value of 1+.

Gaming Area: Same as Basic Training (see 1.15.1).

Deployment: Same as Basic Training (see 1.15.1).

Victory Conditions: Same as Basic Training (see 1.15.1).

Special Rules: All Space Marine units may use the *They Shall Know No Fear* special rule (see *They Shall Know No Fear*), and Assault Marines may use the *Jump Packs* special rule (see 2.1.7).

1.15.5 Combined Arms Training Scenario

In most circumstances, a Space Marine commander will field a combined arms force. This scenario teaches the vital skills needed to weld infantry, artillery and armoured vehicle formations into a single fighting force.

Force Alpha: Two formations each with six Space Marine tactical units and three Rhinos, plus one formation of four Space Marine Assault units, one formation of four Predator Destructors, and one formation of three Whirlwinds. The force has a strategy rating of 5 and all formations have an initiative value of 1+.

Force Beta: Two formations each with six Space Marine tactical units and three Rhinos, plus one formation of four Space Marine Devastator units, one formation of four Predator Destructors, and one formation of three Whirlwinds. The force has a strategy rating of 5 and all formations have an initiative value of 1+.

Gaming Area: Set up a playing area approximately 90–120cm square. Set up any scenery you have in a mutually agreeable manner. You can set up as much or as little scenery as you like, but try to make sure that you have at least a couple of hills and either a built-up area or some woods for the troops to hide behind or take cover in. Place an “objective counter” in the very centre of the battlefield (a coin will do just fine). Then each player must set up another objective 45cms away from any other objective. There should be a total of three objectives once they have all been set up.

Deployment: Same as Basic Training (see 1.15.1).

Victory Conditions: You capture the objective if you have a unit within 15cms of it in the end phase and your opponent does not. To win the game you must capture two objectives and hold them both for one full game turn at the same time.

Special Rules: Same as Advanced Training (see 1.15.4).

DESIGN CONCEPT

Rules Questions

Tabletop wargaming is an imprecise science and can often generate rules questions. The sheer number of variables thrown up by the rules, army lists and varied tabletop terrain pretty much guarantees that at some point during any game you and your opponent will have a discussion about how exactly to deal with a situation that has occurred, or you will find that you play the game using slightly different methods or conventions.

Usually, you will be able to overcome these differences by simply chatting about them with your opponent, but occasionally you will find that you each feel a rule or situation should be interpreted in a diametrically opposed way. Such a situation can lead to a very heated debate that might spoil your enjoyment of the game, and because of this, when these situations occur try not to argue about the rules, and instead simply smile and say “Okay, let’s play it your way!” Trust me, you’ll find that this method of play is much more relaxing and fun than bickering about rules, and you may find that you actually prefer your opponent’s method to your own. It’s also the mature approach, which I think is rather appropriate for a game like Epic, which when all is said and done is designed for experienced wargamers rather than experienced rules lawyers. ‘Nuff said, I hope!

2.0 SPECIALIST UNITS & WEAPONS³¹

“We’re safe ’ere Gobbitz. There’s no way da beakies can get to us at the top of dis cliff...”

Last words of Gibli the Gretchin before being overrun by Space Marine Assault troops from the Salamanders Chapter

The battlefields of the 41st Millennium are home to a vast array of extraordinary units and weapons. These can range from infantry units equipped with jump packs that allow them to fly through the air, through to heavily armoured vehicles equipped with huge macro-weapons so powerful they make a mockery of all but the very thickest armour. These kinds of units have special abilities that often break the core game rules in some way—troops with jump packs can leap over impassable terrain, for example, while units hit by macro-weapons do not get an armour save, and so on. These rules are not particularly complex and you can start using them more or less straight away. We have simply separated them off here so that they do not clutter up the core game rules.

Specialist abilities represent unique attributes for a unit or weapon. Because of this, abilities are not transferable to other units or weapons in the same formation. For example, Terminators are allowed to teleport onto the battlefield and this ability is listed in their profile in the Forces section of the rulebook. However, any other non-Terminator units in the same formation would not have this ability.

Sometimes situations will occur where some units have a special ability and others do not, raising the question of whether the ability may be used. For example, some units in a formation may be able to fire a barrage that ignores cover or has the macro-weapon effect, while other weapons taking part in the barrage do not. If such a situation occurs in a battle then you may only use the ability if all of the units taking part can use it—so the barrage would only ignore cover or count as a macro-weapon if all of the units participating in the barrage had these abilities.

Finally, unless the rules specifically state otherwise then any special abilities can be used by units belonging to a broken formation. Thus a supreme commander, for example, could still use his special abilities even if he was broken.

31. Specialist Units & Weapons

Q: Some special abilities can apply to both units and weapons. Are there any differences?

A: Special abilities on a weapon apply to only to the datasheet line they are on (e.g. Banshee Masks grant first strike to Howling Banshees in close combat and Lictor Talons grant sniper to Lictors in close combat). Special weapon abilities on the unit apply to all attacks where applicable (e.g. Warp Spiders have first strike so all their CC and FF attacks have it, as do any extra attacks added from characters), while special unit abilities on the unit do not (e.g. Eldar Rangers have sniper for their shooting attack while their CC and FF attacks do not).

2.1 SPECIALIST UNITS³²

Some units have special abilities that allow them to “buck the rules” in some way. This is usually because the units themselves are unusual due to their training, equipment or temperament. Any special abilities that apply to a unit will be noted on its datasheet (see 1.1.3).

2.1.1 Characters

Certain units are noted as being *characters*. These units represent important individuals rather than groups of soldiers or the crew of a vehicle or war engine. Because of this they are not represented by a separate model on the tabletop, and are instead *added* to another unit in the army. The unit the character is added to receives any weapons and abilities that the character has noted on their datasheet. For example, Space Marine Chaplains are characters that are armed with a Power Weapon (assault weapon, macro-weapon, extra attack (+1)), and have the *invulnerable save* and *inspiring* abilities. Any unit they are added to will count as having all of these things in addition to their normal weapons and abilities. Note that characters can be added to any type of unit, including vehicles and war engines.

The unit and the character must operate together throughout the entire battle. The character can be transported in any vehicle allowed to transport the unit that he joins, and does not take up an extra space. The character should be represented by a suitable model or command banner that is added to the unit he joins. Characters that are taken as an upgrade for a formation must be added to a unit from the formation they were taken as an upgrade for.

32. Specialist Units

Q: Can a unit have the same special ability more than once?

A: No. Duplicated abilities (from characters being added to the unit, for example) should be treated as occurring once.

Q: Can units being transported use their special abilities?

A: Yes.

Q: Can units that are off board use their special abilities.

A: No, but there are some exceptions. Special abilities that allow the formation to be placed on the table (teleport, tunneler, etc) may obviously be used. Also, any special abilities that affect the formation’s action or rally test (farsight, supreme commander, etc.) may be used, but only on the unit’s formation. Finally, leader and slow and steady may be used off-board.

Q: Can units that are in a broken formation use their special abilities.

A: Yes.

2.1.2 Commanders³³

Some units and characters are noted as being *commanders*. Commanders can order up to three formations of troops to follow them when they make an assault, as long as all the formations have at least one unit within 5cm of a unit from the commander's formation.

Make a single initiative roll for all the formations, counting a -1 modifier if any have Blast markers. If the test is failed then the commander's formation receives a Blast marker and must take a hold action, but the other formations are unaffected (and may take an action later in the turn).

If the test is passed then all three formations may take an engage action. Treat the three formations as if they were a single formation for all rules purposes for the duration of the assault. A 2D6 roll is used to resolve a combined assault. If the attackers lose then each formation is broken. If they win then each formation receives a number of Blast markers equal to the casualties it suffered in the combat.

2.1.3 Fearless³⁴

Some units are noted as being *fearless*. Such units are either exceptionally brave or so crazed that they will never run away even when broken (though you can choose to have them make a withdrawal move if you want them to).

Units that are Fearless are immune to damage from losing an assault (both the additional hits and being wiped out if already broken) and from the damage inflicted by Blast markers if broken. When broken or otherwise forced to take a withdrawal move, Fearless units may choose not to withdraw, and if the unit elects to withdraw it will be destroyed only if it ends its move within 5cm of the enemy rather than 15cm. Fearless units that remain stationary do not take additional damage. Note that other units in the formation that are not fearless will be affected normally by additional hits for Blast markers or losing an assault or whatever—just don't allocate any of the hits to the units that are immune, but hand them out as normal to units that are not.

Fearless units still count as part of a formation, and so will sometimes be “dragged along” as their formation withdraws even though they don't have to, simply in order to stay in formation (see 1.2.1). Finally, note that not needing to withdraw can mean that fearless units can end an assault still in an enemy zone of control, or even in base-to-base contact with the enemy

33. Commanders

Q: Can the commander ability be used if the unit with commander, or its whole formation, is not within 15cm of a unit from the target formation after the charge move?

A: Yes in both cases.

Q: Which initiative value do I use if the following formations have a value different than the commander's formation?

A: Use the initiative value of the activating formation.

34. Fearless

Q: What happens when a broken fearless unit remains in base contact with an enemy unit after losing assault?

A: Nothing special. If the enemy unit does not consolidate out of its zone of control then see 1.7.3. If the units remain in base contact then the opposing formation will automatically be drawn in to an assault on either formation.

(see 1.7.3 for details of how to deal with situations where units start an action in an enemy zone of control).

2.1.4 Infiltrators³⁵

Some units are noted as being *infiltrators*. These are allowed to double their speed when they make a charge move (and only when they charge!), and they can also ignore enemy zones of control from the formation they are charging. These two special abilities allow them to sneak past enemy units when they charge in order to attack enemy units that are further back. Note that the unit coherency rules still apply to infiltrators.

2.1.5 Inspiring³⁶

Some units or characters are noted as being *inspiring*. Each inspiring unit involved in an assault adds +1 to the result roll (as long as it survives the combat of course!)

2.1.6 Invulnerable Saves³⁷

Certain units or characters receive a special *invulnerable save*. These units either have protective devices or supernatural vitality that will allow them to survive an attack that would kill another creature. To represent this, units with an invulnerable save receive a second save of 6+ if they fail their first save for any reason. They may take this second save against any form of attack, even attacks that would normally not allow a save to be taken. No modifiers ever apply to the second save.

2.1.7 Jump Packs

Some units are noted as having *jump packs*. These units are equipped with special devices that allow them to fly for short distances, usually in a series of long “hops”.

Units equipped with jump packs may ignore dangerous or

35. Infiltrators

Q: Can infiltrators double their counter-charge move?

A: No.

Q: Can infiltrators double the distance they are placed from a unit when disembarking as part of a charge move?

A: No.

Q: Can infiltrators move over enemy units?

A: No.

36. Inspiring

Q: Are units from supporting formations considered to be “involved” in an assault?

A: No.

37. Invulnerable Saves

Q: Can invulnerable saves be used by units destroyed by dangerous terrain?

A: No.

Q: Can invulnerable saves be used by units destroyed by the extra hits from the result of an assault?

A: No.

Q: Can invulnerable saves be used by units destroyed from ending their second withdrawal move within 15cm of the enemy?

A: No.

Q: Can invulnerable saves be used by units destroyed from an additional hit from a Blast marker on a broken formation?

A: No.

Q: How many invulnerable saves must a unit make if it is hit by a Titan Killer weapon that causes multiple points of damage?

A: One, unless it is a War Engine in which case it must make one invulnerable save for each point of damage.

impassable terrain as they move (they jump over it). They may not land on impassable terrain, and if they land in dangerous terrain they must take a dangerous terrain test. Units equipped with jump packs may also move over other friendly units as they move, but may not land on them. Units with jump packs are affected by enemy units and zones of control normally, and cannot jump over enemy formations.

2.1.8 Leaders

Some units or characters are noted as being *leaders*. A formation that includes any leaders may remove one extra Blast marker for each leader whenever it regroups or successfully rallies.

2.1.9 Light Vehicles³⁸

Light vehicles include any unarmoured vehicles where the crew is exposed to enemy fire, such as Ork buggies and Space Marine Land Speeders. The only difference between light vehicles and armoured vehicles is that light vehicles can be affected by AP fire as well as AT fire; in effect they count as infantry targets against AP fire and armoured targets against AT fire.

Light vehicles rely on speed and agility to protect them from enemy fire, and because of this their saving throw is based on these factors rather than the thickness of any armour they may carry. This aside, their saving throw works in exactly the same manner as the saving throw of any other unit, and will be ignored by macro-weapons, can be used against barrages, and so on.

2.1.10 Mounted

Some infantry units are noted as being *mounted*, and will either ride on bikes or living creatures such as horses. Mounted units count as vehicles for terrain effects, and as infantry units for all other purposes.

2.1.11 Reinforced Armour³⁹

Units with *reinforced armour* are protected by armour many times thicker than that found on most armoured vehicles and have extremely robust internal construction too. Because of this they still take their saving throw when hit by macro-weapons (see 2.2.6). In addition, they may re-roll a failed save against any non-macro-weapon hit, including those inflicted during an assault.

2.1.12 Scouts⁴⁰

Some units are noted as being *scouts*. These units are trained to operate on their own, scouting ahead of their formation to seek out the enemy. Scout units only have to remain within 20cm of another unit from their formation, rather than 5cm as would normally be the case. In addition, scouts are trained to spread out so they can cover a wide area, and so have a 10cm zone of control. Note that these abilities only apply to scout units and

cannot be transferred to other units in the same formation or transport units carrying the scouts.

2.1.13 Skimmers⁴¹

Some units are noted as being *skimmers*. These units are equipped with devices that allow them to hover a short distance above the ground, so that they can fly over terrain that would slow other units down. Note that skimmers do *not* follow any of the rules for aircraft in Section 4.0.

Skimmers may ignore dangerous or impassable terrain as they move. They may not land on impassable terrain, and if they land in dangerous terrain they must take a dangerous terrain test.

40. Scouts

Q: How do formations that contain scout and non-scout units form a “chain” to be a legal formation?

A: Every non-scout unit must be within 5cm of at least one other unit while scout units must be within 20cm of at least one other unit.

Q: Are scouts intermingled if they are within 10cm of another formation?

A: No.

Q: Can a charging unit move into base contact with an enemy unit that is completely within an un-intermingled enemy scout’s zone of control?

A: Yes, but only if the enemy unit is closer than the scout. In this instance you may enter the zone of control of a formation that is not the target of the assault.

41. Skimmers

Q: Can a skimmer transport unit pick up a unit that is in terrain that is dangerous to the skimmer?

A: Yes, but if the unit being picked up was completely within the dangerous terrain then the skimmer would have to take a dangerous terrain test.

Q: Can a skimmer transport unit pick up a unit that is in terrain that is impassable to the skimmer?

A: Yes, but only if the unit being picked up is not completely within the impassable terrain.

Q: Does a skimmer that starts a move in dangerous terrain have to take a dangerous terrain test.

A: Yes.

Q: Can a skimmer pop up as part of a hold action where it is shooting?

A: No. While it is not specifically stated in the rules you have to be able to move to pop up (overwatch being the only exception).

Q: Can a skimmer pop up as part of a counter charge?

A: Yes, if the unit can move it can pop up.

Q: If a skimmer chooses to use its firefight value in an assault when in base contact with an enemy unit are both units still considered to be in base-to-base contact?

A: Yes.

Q: What happens if two skimmers are in base contact with each other?

A: If either player chooses to use their skimmer’s firefight value they both use their firefight value. Otherwise, they use their close combat value.

Q: If a unit is in base contact with a skimmer that chooses to use its firefight value and another non-skimmer unit can it still use its close combat value?

A: Yes.

Q: Can a war engine skimmer choose to use its firefight against units in base contact with it?

A: Yes.

Q: Two skimmers in an assault are in base contact with enemy units. One uses its close combat and the other its firefight. The enemy inflicts one hit on them, can the skimmer in firefight be allocated the hit?

A: Rules as written, yes. However, players doing so should be publicly shamed and ridiculed.

38. Light Vehicles

Q: Can light vehicles grant the -1 to hit modifier to infantry units touching them?

A: No.

39. Reinforced Armour

Q: Can a unit with reinforced armour re-roll an invulnerable save against a non-macro-weapon hit?

A: No.

Q: Can a unit with reinforced armour re-roll a cover save against a non-macro-weapon hit?

A: Yes, but only using its armour value.

Skimmers may also move over other friendly units as they move, but may not land on them. Enemy units and zones of control affect skimmers normally.

A skimmer may declare that it is *popping up* at the start of any action that it takes, including when the skimmer goes into overwatch. A skimmer may not pop up as part of a sustained fire action or a marshal action, but may pop-up when it goes onto overwatch. Popping up counts as movement for the purposes of triggering firing by enemy units on overwatch.

A skimmer that has popped up, “pops down” at the conclusion of the action. Skimmers on overwatch do not pop down until after they make their overwatch attack. Skimmers with a transport capacity may not embark or disembark units while they are popped up, and if they are destroyed while they are popped up then any units on board will be destroyed with no save.

A skimmer that has popped up is assumed to be flying high enough that nearby intervening terrain that is closer to the skimmer than the target does not block the line of fire. To check if the line of fire is blocked, simply measure the distance between the skimmer and the terrain, and then measure the distance between the terrain and the target unit. If the skimmer is nearer to the intervening terrain then the line of fire is not blocked. If the skimmer is further from the terrain, then work out the line of fire normally. If the distance is equal, then both the skimmer and the target unit can fire at each other, but they both count as being in cover and the cover to hit modifier will apply.

Skimmers may always choose to use their firefight value in an assault, even if there are enemy units in base contact with the skimmer. If they do this then the enemy must use their firefight value also. This represents the skimmer lifting off the ground out of reach of enemy ground units.

2.1.14 Sniper⁴²

Some infantry units are noted as being *snipers*. Roll separately when attacking with a sniper unit. If they hit, the attacker can choose which enemy unit is hit from those within range and in the line of fire of the sniper unit. In addition the target suffers a -1 save modifier.

42. Sniper

Q: Can the sniper ability be used in an assault?

A: Only if it is on an assault weapons or small arms weapon.

Q: What units may an attacker choose to hit with sniper hits in an assault?

A: Any enemy units within 15cm and in the line of fire of the unit, regardless if the hit was from an assault weapons or small arms weapon.

Q: When are sniper hits allocated?

A: Before or after regular hits but before saving throws are made (and thus before macro-weapon hits are allocated).

Q: Can a sniper hit be allocated to a unit that has already been allocated a regular hit?

A: Yes.

2.1.15 Supreme Commanders⁴³

Supreme Commanders represent high-level command units. They count as commanders and leaders (see 2.1.2 and 2.1.8 respectively). In addition, each supreme commander unit in the army allows a player to re-roll one failed initiative test (of any type) once per turn.

2.1.16 Thick Rear Armour

Some armoured units are noted as having *thick rear armour*. These vehicles have equally thick armour all round, and so ignore the -1 save modifier when they are caught in a crossfire.

2.1.17 Teleport⁴⁴

Units with the *teleport* ability can appear suddenly on the battlefield, either because they have access to technological or arcane devices that allow them to be instantaneously moved from one place to another, or because they are capable of hiding extremely well and then suddenly appear “as if from nowhere”.

Formations where all of the units have this ability may be kept off the table, and can appear at the start of any turn. Simply place the unit anywhere you like on the table at the start of any turn, before determining who wins the strategy roll. The unit must be placed within 5cms of another unit from its own formation if there are any already in play. So, for example, if a whole formation teleported into play then the first unit could be placed anywhere, but any other units would need to be placed within 5cms of a unit that had already been placed. All units must be placed outside enemy zones of control. If placed in dangerous terrain then a dangerous terrain test must be taken when the unit is placed on the table.

Teleporting is an inherently dangerous business, and doesn’t always go as planned. To represent this roll a D6 for each unit that teleports into play. On a roll of a 1 the formation that the unit belongs to receives a Blast marker.

2.1.18 Walkers

Some vehicle units are noted as being *walkers*. They are able to negotiate dangerous terrain more easily than other vehicles. To represent this they may re-roll any failed dangerous terrain tests.

43. Supreme Commanders

Q: Can an army have more than one supreme commander?

A: Yes, although the tournament army lists assume a maximum of one.

Q: What is an initiative test?

A: An action or rally test.

44. Teleport

Q: Can a formation that contains transport units with teleport and transported units without it still teleport in?

A: Yes, but any units that can’t be transported should be considered destroyed.

Q: Can a unit with teleport and scout teleport onto the board and set up within 20cm from each other?

A: No, all units after the first need to be placed within 5cms of a unit that has already been placed.

Q: How many D6 should a war engine unit roll when it teleports into play?

A: A number equal to its starting damage capacity.

Re-rolls

Sometimes the rules will allow you to re-roll a dice if you don't like the first score you rolled. Re-rolls always apply to single dice rolls—if you rolled more than one dice then the re-roll will only allow you to re-roll one of them unless the rules specifically say otherwise. No dice may be re-rolled more than once (you can't re-roll a re-roll) and you must accept the result of the second roll.

2.1.19 Slow and Steady

Some spacecraft units are noted as being *slow and steady*. They may not be used on the first two turns of a battle unless the scenario specifically says otherwise.

2.1.20 Support Craft⁴⁵

Support craft are much like a hybrid between a skimmer and an aircraft. They remain high up in the air, hovering over the battlefield, firing over intervening terrain when possible. Support craft function identically to a skimmer unit that is always “popped up”. Support craft fire and are fired at normally (i.e. anti-aircraft ability is not required). In an assault, support craft automatically force a firefight in the same manner skimmers may choose. It is assumed that support craft transports or the troops they carry are appropriately equipped to embark and disembark troops as normal.

2.1.21 Self Planetfall

Self planetfall is plotted exactly as planetfall (see 4.4). Both the turn in which the formation arrives and the landing location is plotted. The only exception is that, because these units are much smaller than orbiting spacecraft, they may be plotted to arrive in the same turn that an enemy spacecraft is present.

On the designated turn the self planetfalling unit is activated in the normal activation sequence, as with spacecraft. Nominate the action for the formation and roll to activate. If the unit fails to activate its arrival is delayed to the next following turn. If the activation is successful, place the formation at the plotted landing zone and determine scatter according to 4.4 as if it were a normal planetfall, including loaded units disembarking up to 5cm. The formation's action proceeds as normal in all respects from that point. In other words, the formation gets the “free move” from planetfall placement at the beginning of its action but in all other ways activates as normal.

Note: The action is chosen at activation, before scatter is determined. Choose the action carefully as a poor scatter role could render some actions ineffective.

2.1.22 Expendable

Some units are seen by their allies as ablative or just plain disposable. This may be because the units are specifically created to sacrifice themselves or because the units are simply not valued.

A formation does not receive a Blast marker when a unit with *expendable* is destroyed, this includes the extra Blast marker from the first casualty of a crossfire and for units destroyed for being out of formation after a move.

If an expendable unit is hit by a weapon with disrupt it does not inflict a Blast marker. If a formation is comprised completely of expendable units then they do not benefit from any of the rules above.

Expendable units killed in an assault count for the purposes of working out its result (see 1.12.7).

2.1.23 Tunneler

Formations where all of the units have *tunneler* (or are transported in units that have the ability) may be kept off the table and can appear at the start of the second turn or after. Set up the units touching their own side's table edge before the battle starts at the same time that spacecraft are setup (see 4.3.1). Any units transported in the tunneler should be placed to one side at this time too.

Secretly write down the location where the tunneler will surface at the same time and in the same manner that you record the coordinates of a drop zone (see 4.3.1). You must also secretly record when the tunneler will surface. If it is going to surface in your half of the table it may arrive from the second turn onwards. If it is going to surface in the opposing half of the table, it may arrive from turn three onwards.

Set up the tunneler at the start of the stated turn, before placing units with teleport, at the location you wrote down. Any units being transported are allowed to disembark immediately upon surfacing. Surfacing does not count as movement for the purposes of triggering overwatch fire. Disembarking triggers overwatch fire as normal.

If the tunneler surfaces on terrain that is impassable for it, under a friendly unit, or in an enemy zone of control then it is assumed that on-board sensor equipment will divert it towards another entry point. The unit should be moved by the opposing player to the nearest area where it can surface.

Formations of multiple tunneler need only record one location where they will surface. Place a unit at this location, or within 5cm of another unit that has already been placed, so long as all units are placed within 15cm of the location and on the appropriate half of the table.

Tunnelers, and any units being transported in them, may take an action on the turn they appear.

2.1.24 Self-Reliant

Some units or characters are noted as being *self-reliant*. A formation that includes one or more self-reliant units may remove one extra Blast marker whenever it regroups or successfully rallies. Multiple self-reliant units in a formation does not allow it to remove multiple Blast markers, simply check for the presence of one or more self-reliant units and remove one Blast marker if they are found.

Some self-reliant units may have a trailing number noted in parentheses (e.g. *self-reliant* (x)). If this is the case, remove a

45. Support Craft

Q: Can a unit with jump packs be placed within 15cms when disembarked from a support craft?

A: No.

number of Blaster markers equal to “x” instead (e.g. a formation of *self-reliant* (2) units would remove two Blast markers instead of one). If a unit has multiple self-reliant abilities then use the one with the greatest number and ignore the rest. Similarly, if a formation contains units with different self-reliant abilities then use the one with the greatest number and ignore the rest.

2.2 SPECIALIST WEAPONS

Some exotic or powerful weapons have special abilities to represent their unique properties. Any special abilities that apply to a weapon will be noted in the line for the weapon on a unit’s datasheet.

2.2.1 Anti-aircraft Weapons

Some of the weapons used in Epic are used in dogfights or to defend against aircraft. These weapons are collectively known as anti-aircraft weapons in the rules. Anti-aircraft weapons have an “AA” firepower value, in addition they may also have AP or AT firepower values. For example, the Space Marine Hunter has a Firepower value of AT4+/AA4+. The rules for carrying out AA shooting are described in full in the rules for Aerospace Operations (see 4.0).

2.2.2 Disrupt⁴⁶

Certain weapons are designed to disrupt enemy formations as much as kill enemy troops. To represent this weapons noted as having the disrupt ability inflict a Blast marker on an enemy formation for each hit they inflict instead of for each kill they inflict. Note that the hits inflicted by disruptor weapons are saved for normally. Any units that fail their save are removed as casualties but do not cause a second Blast marker to be placed on the target formation.

2.2.3 Extra Attacks⁴⁷

Some assault and close combat weapons are noted as having *extra attacks* (+x). Units armed with these weapons receive a number of extra attacks equal to “x” during an assault. For example, an assault weapon noted as having “extra attacks (+2)” would allow the unit using it to make two extra close combat attacks in an assault. Sometimes the entry will specify a dice roll rather than a fixed number. For example, a weapon that had “extra attacks (D3)” would attack D3 times each time it attacked. Extra attacks can apply to shooting attacks, close combat attacks, and firefight attacks.

46. Disrupt

Q: Does a disrupt hit inflict a Blast marker on an expendable unit?

A: No.

Q: Does a disrupt hit inflict a Blast marker when it takes down a void shield or power field?

A: No.

Q: A disrupt hit destroys a transport unit carrying other units. Do these units count as being hit by the disrupt hit?

A: No. Note that Blast markers should still be placed if the transported units are destroyed however.

47. Extra Attacks

Q: How do special abilities apply to a weapon with extra attacks?

A: Special abilities (unit or weapon) that are on a weapon with extra attacks apply to, and only to, the extra attacks. All special weapon abilities (e.g. first strike) on the unit are also inherited by the extra attacks, but special unit abilities (e.g. sniper) on the unit are not.

Q: If a unit has an extra attack on a Small Arms weapon, can it be used if the unit is in base contact with an enemy unit?

A: Only if the unit is a war engine, and that hit can only be allocated to units in firefight with the war engine.

2.2.4 First Strike⁴⁸

Weapons with the first strike ability attack first in an assault. Resolve the attack and inflict damage for the weapon before any enemy units make their attacks. This may result in some enemy units being destroyed before they can attack. If the ability is noted for a weapon with extra attacks (see 2.2.3) then only the extra attacks gets the first strike ability; otherwise it will count for all close combat attacks if noted for an assault weapon, or all firefight attacks if noted for small arms. If opposing units both have first strike weapons then all first strike attacks are resolved simultaneously and their results applied to both sides before other attacks are resolved.

2.2.5 Ignore Cover

Some weapons are noted as being able to *ignore cover*. These weapons are designed to negate the effects of cover, either by blasting it apart or simply bypassing it altogether. These weapons ignore cover to hit modifiers, and negate infantry cover saves.

2.2.6 Macro-Weapons⁴⁹

Some of the weapons used in Epic are absolutely huge. These weapons are collectively known as *macro-weapons* in the rules. Only units with reinforced armour or invulnerable saves receive a saving throw against hits from a macro-weapon (see 2.1.6 and 2.1.11). Any other type of target that is hit does not get a saving throw at all. The following rules explain in detail how this works, but as long as you bear in mind the principle that macro-weapons cancel saves then you won't go too far wrong.

Shooting Attacks: Macro-weapons that can be used for shooting attacks do not have AP or AT firepower values. Instead they have a “macro-weapon” value (abbreviated to MW). For example, the volcano cannon mounted on an Imperial Warlord Titan has a fire value of MW 2+. You should roll to hit normally when firing a macro-weapon. Macro-weapons can affect any type of target, so the volcano cannon mentioned above would hit any type of target on a roll of 2+. Only units with reinforced armour or invulnerable saves receive a saving throw against hits from a macro-weapon (see 2.1.6 and 2.1.11). Any other type of target that is hit does not get a saving throw. Cover saves are also negated, although the -1 to hit modifier does apply. Units on board a transport vehicle destroyed by a macro-weapon only receive a save if they would have one were they hit by the macro-weapon directly.

48. First Strike

Q: A unit in base contact uses a first strike extra attack and the enemy unit is removed. Can the unit still use its CC value for its regular attack?

A: Only if it was in base contact with another enemy unit, otherwise it would have to use its FF value.

Q: How does first strike work with supporting fire?

A: First strike doesn't provide a benefit in this situation, treat it like normal.

49. Macro-Weapons

Q: A transport unit is destroyed but the units being transported survive and are placed in base contact with an AV, may Macro-weapon hits be allocated to them?

A: Yes.

Q: If a unit in an assault with an macro-weapon attack is destroyed by a regular hit before macro-weapon hits are allocated is its macro-weapon attack disguard?

A: No. All attacks in assault are simultaneous, macro-weapon hits are just allocated after regular attacks.

Barrages: Work out the macro-weapon's barrage normally, except that any units hit do not receive a saving throw unless they have reinforced armour or an invulnerable save.

Assaults: In an assault, some small arms and assault weapons that are allowed extra attacks can have the macro-weapon ability as well. In this case the macro-weapon ability *only* applies to the extra attacks.

Allocating Hits: If an attacking formation scores hits both with normal weapons and weapons with the macro-weapon ability, then the opposing player must allocate and make any saves for the normal hits first, and then allocate and make any saves for the macro-weapon hits. Hits from macro-weapons can only be applied to units that are in a position to be hit by a macro-weapon.

2.2.7 Single Shot⁵⁰

Some weapons are noted as being *single shot*. These weapons may be used once per battle and may not then be fired again. You may want to record which single shot weapons have been fired on a piece of scrap paper.

2.2.8 Slow Firing⁵¹

Some weapons are noted as being *slow firing*. These weapons must take one turn to reload after they have fired. This means that if they fire on one turn they may not fire during the next. We have found that the best way of remembering this is simply to turn the unit around to face away from the enemy when it fires, and then turn it back again when the formation is activated again next turn, but you can use any method you prefer.

2.2.9 Titan Killers

Some weapons are noted as being *Titan Killers*. Enemy units hit by such weapons may not take a cover or armour save, even if they have reinforced armour. In addition, further special rules apply if the target unit is a war engine (see 3.0). In all other ways, Titan killers are treated as macro-weapons.

2.2.10 Indirect Fire⁵²

Some weapons that can fire barrages are noted as having the *indirect fire* ability. Units armed with indirect fire weapons are allowed to fire indirectly if their formation takes a sustained fire

50. Single Shot

Q: Can a single shot weapon that has fired count for suppression purposes?

A: Yes.

51. Slow Firing

Q: If a slow firing weapon's firepower is preceded by a multiplier do all of the shots have to be used?

A: No, shots can be saved and used during the following turn while the weapon is reloading.

Q: Can a slow firing weapon that has fired all its shots count for suppression purposes on the turn it is reloading?

A: Yes.

52. Indirect Fire

Q: Does a weapon firing indirectly ignore the -1 to hit modifier if the target is in cover.

A: If the target would receive the modifier just for being partially obscured then yes. If the target is in the cover then no, it would still benefit from the -1 to hit modifier.

action. Units belonging to a formation that fails the action test may shoot normally as part of their hold action, but may not fire indirectly. Units firing an indirect barrage receive the +1 modifier for taking a sustained fire action. In addition, no line of fire is required for an indirect barrage, as it is assumed that the barrage is fired high in the air so that the shots rain down on the target and ignore any intervening terrain. Co-ordinates for the barrage are provided by “spotters” that are either in other friendly formations that do have a line of fire, or from orbiting spy satellites or planes. Finally, the high trajectory used by weapons firing indirectly greatly increases their range, but means they cannot fire at targets that are too close by. To represent this, weapons firing indirectly double their range, but have a minimum range of 30cms.

2.3 SPECIALIST TRAINING SCENARIOS

“Why, if it isn’t Brother Marius. The injuries from the last training exercise have healed well I see. And that new bionic eye should prove most useful for this next exercise. Tell me, how many hours have you had on Land Speeders up to now?”

Veteran Sergeant Kesser

There are a huge number of specialist units and weapons covered by the Epic rules, far too many to be covered in a single training scenario. However, the following variant of the Combined Arms training scenario can give you a taste of what effect specialist units can have on the game. In order to play the scenario you will need access to the models you used for the Combined Arms scenario, plus models for the units shown on the datasheet section below.

Note: The datasheets for this scenario are in Section 5.0.

2.3.1 Specialist Training Scenario

Space Marines are organised into companies led by hugely experienced and respected commanders, and backed up with heavily armoured Land Raiders and highly agile Land Speeders. These specialised units allow a force to be tailored to carry out any mission the company may be called upon to undertake.

Force Alpha: Two formations each with six Space Marine Tactical units and three Rhinos, plus one formation of four Land Raiders and one formation of five Land Speeders. One Tactical formation may include a Space Marine Commander and the other may include a Space Marine Dreadnought. The force has a strategy rating of 5 and all formations have an initiative value of 1+.

Force Beta: Two formations each with six Space Marine Tactical units and three Rhinos, plus one formation of four Land Raiders and one formation of five Land Speeders. One Tactical formation may include a Space Marine Commander and the other may include a Space Marine Dreadnought. The force has a strategy rating of 5 and all formations have an initiative value of 1+.

Gaming Area: Set up a playing area approximately 90–120cm square. Set up any scenery you have in a mutually agreeable manner. You can set up as much or as little scenery as you like, but try to make sure that you have at least a couple of hills and either a built-up area or some woods for the troops to hide behind or take cover in. Place an “objective counter” in the very centre of the battlefield (a coin will do just fine). Then each player must set up another objective 45cms away from any other objective. There should be a total of three objectives once they have all been set up.

Deployment: If one player sets up the scenery then his opponent can choose which table edge to deploy on. If you set up the scenery together then dice to see who gets the choice of edge. The other player sets up on the opposite table edge. You must deploy all of your units within 15cms of your table edge.

Special Rules: All Space Marine units may use the “They Shall Know No Fear” special rule (see *They Shall Know No Fear*).

Victory Conditions: You capture the objective if you have a

unit within 15cms of it in the end phase and your opponent does not. To win the game you must capture two objectives and hold them both for one full game turn.

3.0 WAR ENGINES

“How much like a god he is, that ancient machine, primal of all his kind! His mighty fists, massive like two towers of destruction, laden with the doom of mankind’s bitter foes. He watches over us now as battle joins, and in his shadow we shall advance upon our enemies and defeat them.”

The battlefields of the 41st Millennium are home to some awesomely large vehicles, many of which tower high above the battlefield and carry weapons batteries of terrifying potency. Most famous of all of these are the Titans created by the Adeptus Mechanicus of the Imperium, but there are many others including the Gargants fielded by Ork armies and the living bio-Titans fielded by the Tyranids. All of these creations are referred to as *war engines* in the Epic rules.

War engines include all very large machines, such as Ork Gargants, Imperial Titans, Imperial Guard Baneblades and Space Marine Thunderhawk Gunships. Because of their huge size and awesome toughness, war engines are very different to other units, and because of this many of the core game rules are modified when it comes to war engines.

That said, the main difference between a war engine and a normal vehicle is that the war engine has a *damage capacity* (abbreviated DC) that shows how many “kills” the war engine can absorb before it is destroyed. For example, a Warlord Titan has a DC of 8, and it therefore takes eight “kills” to destroy it. For most rules purposes, a war engine counts as being “worth” a number of units equal to its starting damage capacity, so a war engine’s starting damage capacity is also used to work out how many dice it rolls in an assault, how easy it is to pin and so on. This and all of the other modifications to the core game rules are described in detail as follows.

3.1 WAR ENGINE MOVEMENT⁵³

War engines follow the same movement rules as any other unit. War engines that fail a dangerous terrain test suffer a hit (see the damage rules below).

3.1.1 War Engine Formations⁵⁴

War engines are so large they usually operate as single units. Although only one unit, the war engine is still a separate formation, and all of the rules that apply to formations apply to it also.

Some smaller war engines like Baneblades operate in formations of more than one unit. War engines count as being within formation coherency distance if they are within a distance equal to their starting damage capacity × 5cm of another unit from the formation. For example, a Baneblade has a starting damage capacity of 3, and so will be in formation as long as it is within (3×5) = 15cm of another unit.

3.1.2 War Engine Zones Of Control

War engines have a zone of control like any other unit. In an assault they only lose their zone of control once they have been charged by a number of units equal to their starting damage capacity.

53. War Engine Movement

Q: What happens to a war engine that fails a dangerous terrain test?

A: It takes a point of damage (check for a critical hit), but does not take a blast marker.

54. War Engine Formations

Q: How do formations that contain war engine and non-war engine units form a “chain” to be a legal formation?

A: Every non-war engine unit must be within 5cm of at least one other unit while war engine units must be within a distance equal to their starting damage capacity × 5cm of at least one other unit.

3.1.3 Transport War Engines⁵⁵

Some war engines are capable of transporting other units. These war engines are an exception to the rule that transport vehicles may only carry units from their own formation. Instead a war engine transport vehicle can carry units from another formation, as long as the entire formation can fit inside the war engine, and as long as the entire formation mounts up as part of the same move. Note that a war engine may carry other units from its own formation using the normal rules (see 1.7.5).

For a formation to mount up in this way the units that are getting on board must be able to move into base contact with the war engine during their action. The war engine is allowed to have taken an action before the other formation mounts up, but may not take an action after they have done so. While being transported the units may not shoot or carry out any other actions except to rally in the end phase (see 1.14.1).

Once the units being transported have mounted up, the war engine can move off with them inside as part of one of its own actions in a subsequent turn. It can dismount the transported units at the end of a move in the same way as a normal transport vehicle (i.e., the units are placed within 5cms of the transport at the end of a move).

Formations that dismount in this way may not take an action in the turn they dismount, but are allowed to either shoot or fight in an assault if the war engine that was transporting it is able to shoot or assault. In both cases, the war engine and the transported units are treated as a single formation until the shooting attack or assault has been resolved. The war engine and the formation that disembarked are treated as being separate formations once the war engine has completely resolved its action.

For example, a war engine could take a double action and disembark any troops it was carrying at the end of its move. The war engine and the disembarked units could then shoot together at a target formation, but all shooting would suffer the -1 modifier for shooting while taking a double action. Alternatively a war engine could take an engage action and dismount any transported units at the end of its charge move. It and the disembarking units would be treated as a single formation for the purposes of resolving the assault, as if they were making a combined assault (see 2.1.2, paragraph 3).

55. Transport War Engines

Q: Can a war engine transport more than one formation?

A: Yes.

Q: Can a formation of war engines split another formation of troops amongst them to transport?

A: No, a single war engine from a separate formation cannot transport part of another formation.

Q: Are units trapped inside a war engine if it is in base contact with two enemy units?

A: No, only if it is in base contact with a number of enemy units equal to twice its starting damage capacity.

3.2 WAR ENGINE SHOOTING

The following special rules apply when shooting either at or with war engines. In general, war engines are treated in the same manner as armoured vehicle targets (i.e., any hit that would affect an armoured vehicle can affect a war engine). Any exceptions to this are noted below.

3.2.1 Allocating Hits To War Engines⁵⁶

Normally, you may only allocate one hit to a unit in a formation until all units in the formation have been allocated one hit each. This doesn't apply to war engines. Instead, the defender allocates a number of hits equal to the war engine's starting damage capacity before he allocates any hits to other units.

If a formation includes both war engines and non-war engine units then an attacker must state whether any attacks he makes on the formation will be directed at the war engines or the other units in the formation. Attacks directed at the war engines can only be allocated against war engines if they hit, while attacks directed at other units may not be allocated to the war engines in the formation.

Special rules apply to war engines that are attacked by weapons that use templates (see 1.9.8). Normally these weapons attack each unit that falls under the template once each. However, due to its huge size if a war engine lies directly under the centre of a template, then it is subjected to a number of attacks equal to half its starting damage capacity, rounding fractions up. For example, a Baneblade (DC3) caught under the centre of a template would be attacked twice. You may wish to make sure that your barrage templates have a small hole in the centre so that you can see if a war engine suffers the full effect of the bombardment or is only attacked once.

3.2.2 War Engine Damage Capacity

Unlike normal vehicles, war engines are able to absorb more than one hit before they are destroyed. The number of hits a war engine can take is shown by its damage capacity. Each hit that is not saved will reduce the war engine's damage capacity by 1 point, and the war engine is only destroyed once its damage capacity is reduced to 0. Place one Blast marker on the war engine's formation for each point of damage that it suffers.

56. Allocating Hits To War Engines

Q: How many units does a war engine in the target formation count as with regards to placing a barrage template?

A: A number equal to its starting damage capacity.

Q: If a war engine is under multiple templates from the same barrage is it subject to more attacks than normal?

A: No.

3.2.3 Critical Hits⁵⁷

The weapons used in Epic are so destructive that they have the ability to destroy or damage even the largest target if they hit the right place. To represent this, any hit on a war engine (no matter how it was inflicted) has a chance of causing critical damage. Roll a D6 for each hit scored on a war engine. On a roll of 1–5 the target suffers normal damage and its damage capacity is reduced by 1 point. On a roll of a 6 the hit has caused critical damage; the war engine still loses one point of damage capacity, but in addition suffers a critical hit.

The effect of a critical hit is listed on the war engine's datasheet and will vary from one type of war engine to another. For example, Imperial Titans are vulnerable to hits on their dangerously unstable plasma reactors, while Ork Gargants are renowned for catching fire, and so on.

If a war engine suffers more than one critical hit then the effects of all of the hits are cumulative.

3.2.4 Blast Markers⁵⁸

Every time a war engine loses a point of damage then the formation it is part of receives one Blast marker. If a war engine is destroyed by the effect of a critical hit then the formation it belongs to receives a number of extra Blast markers equal to the damage capacity the war engine would have had remaining were it not destroyed. For example, if a previously undamaged Baneblade in a Super Heavy Tank Company were destroyed by a single critical hit then the company would receive three Blast markers.

It requires a number of Blast markers equal to a war engine's starting damage capacity to suppress or break a war engine. Add the starting damage capacity of any functioning war engines in a formation together in order to find out how many Blast markers are required to break the formation. If the formation includes units that are not war engines, then add the starting damage

capacity of any functioning war engines in the formation to the number of other non-war engine units to find the formation's break point. For example, an Ork formation with a Battlefortress (DC3) and six Boyz would be broken by $3+6 = 9$ Blast markers. War engines rally using the normal rules.

A broken war engine is assumed to have a number of Blast markers equal to its starting damage capacity for all rules purposes. If there are any enemy units within 15cms of the war engine after it makes a withdrawal then it suffers one extra point of damage (no save allowed) for each enemy unit that is within 15cms. Additional hits caused by losing an assault or receiving Blast markers while broken cause one point of damage each. Roll for critical hits from these extra hits as you would normally.

3.2.5 Titan Killer Weapons

Some units are armed with weapons that are noted as being Titan Killers (see 2.2.9). Many of these weapons are capable of taking down a war engine with a single shot. Enemy units hit by such weapons may not take a cover or armour save, even if they have reinforced armour. Note that cover to hit modifiers do apply.

In addition, Titan Killer weapons will usually have a dice roll noted in brackets on their data sheet. For example, the Volcano Cannon mounted on an Imperial Guard Shadowsword is noted as being a Titan Killer (D3) weapon. If such a weapon hits a war engine then the war engine suffers damage equal to the roll of the appropriate sort of dice. Each point of damage will reduce the war engine's damage capacity by 1 point. Roll for critical hits for each point of damage inflicted. Titan Killer weapons that do not have a dice roll in brackets only inflict one point of damage.

When allocating Titan killer hits that may cause multiple points of damage, roll for damage immediately after allocating the hit. The War Engine counts as having been allocated a number of hits equal to the damage rolled. This is solely for purposes of allocation. Damage is applied as normal, only after all hits have been allocated.

57. Critical Hits

Q: Does the "hit" here refer to hits that have been allocated to the war engine or to hits that have reduced the war engine's damage capacity by 1 point?

A: Hits that have reduced the war engine's damage capacity by 1 point.

Q: If a critical hit's effect causes additional hits do these have a chance of causing critical damage?

A: Yes.

Q: If a critical hit's effect is resolved in the end phase and this results in another critical hit is that resolved immediately?

A: No, it would be resolved in the next turn's end phase.

Q: If a critical hit's effect destroys units in another formation does that formation receive a Blast marker for coming under fire?

A: No.

Q: If a critical hit's effect destroys units during an assault are those units counted for the purposes of working out the result of the assault?

A: If the units' formation was part of the assault, yes.

Q: Are critical hit effects cumulative?

A: Yes.

58. Blast Markers

Q: Does a war engine's formation receive a Blast marker if its critical hit effect causes a point of damage?

A: Yes.

EXAMPLE OF PLAY

Titan Killer Weapons

A formation of Shadowswords scores 3 Titan Killer (D3) hits against a pair of Warhounds. The first hit is allocated and the roll for damage is 2. The first Warhound counts as having 2 hits allocated to it. Because it has 3 Damage Capacity, the front Warhound can still be allocated an additional hit. The second Titan Killer hit is therefore applied to the front Warhound. The die is again a 2. Multiple Titan Killer hits don't "spill over" to other units in the formation, so the lead Warhound will take all 4 hits. As the number of hits allocated exceeds the Damage Capacity of the lead Warhound, the final Titan Killer hit will be allocated to the second Warhound. Note that even if the lead Warhound had been damaged and the 2 points of Titan Killer damage from the first shot would be enough to destroy it, damage is only applied after allocation. The Warhound would remain in play until all hits were allocated exactly as above. Once allocation was complete, the damage would be applied and the Warhound removed.

3.3 WAR ENGINE ASSAULTS⁵⁹

War engines can be devastating in an assault, which is reflected by the following special rules.

3.3.1 Charge Moves⁶⁰

When a war engine charges it is allowed to “barge” any non-war engine units belonging to the target formation out of the way and carry on with its charge move. Move the war engine as far as desired, and then place any units that were barged out of the way as close as you can to their starting point, while still touching the base of the war engine that so rudely pushed them aside. The maximum number of units a war engine can barge aside in this manner is two per point of its starting damage capacity. Note that war engines may not barge other war engines out of the way.

The rule that no more than two units may move into base contact with an enemy unit when they charge does not apply to war engines. Instead a war engine may be charged by up to two enemy units per point of its starting damage capacity (i.e., a Baneblade with a DC of 3 could be contacted by up to six enemy units).

3.3.2 Close Combat and Firefight Attacks

Instead of rolling a single hit dice for each war engine in an assault, roll a number of hit dice equal to the war engine’s starting damage capacity. You may choose to split these between close combat rolls and firefight rolls as you see fit, but close combat rolls will only hit enemy units in base contact, while firefight rolls will only hit units within 15cm that are not in base contact.

3.3.3 Result Rolls

When working out the result of an assault that includes a war engine, count each point of damage inflicted on a war engine as a “casualty”. Each surviving war engine counts as a number of units equal to its starting damage capacity when working out if one side outnumbers the other. If a war engine loses an assault, then it takes one extra point of damage for each point it lost the assault by. Roll for critical hits normally.

59. War Engine Assaults

Q: Can a war engine transporting a broken formation assault?

A: Yes, but any broken formations being transported may not disembark and fight in the assault. If they are forced to disembark due to the war engine being destroyed then they are destroyed as well. Note that They do count as taking part in the assault, however, and affect the assault modifiers when working out the result.

Q: Can a unit use its consolidation move to get into a war engine?

A: Yes, but the war engine may not make a consolidation move.

60. Charge Moves

Q: Can a war engines barge units out of the way with a counter charge?

A: Yes.

Q: Can a war engine barge one formation and assault another?

A: No, a unit can’t enter an enemy’s zone of control unless it is assaulting the unit’s formation.

Q: Can a war engine barge a unit and then move away from other units to deny attacks?

A: Yes, but only if the war engine doesn’t enter the other units’ zone of control. A war engine is still required to move into base contact with an enemy unit if it enters its zone of control.

Q: How many units does a war engine making a charge move count as when moving into base contact with an enemy unit?

A: One. A war engine may have a number of units equal to twice its starting damage capacity in base contact with it but it still only counts as one unit when it moves into base contact with another unit (i.e., a Baneblade with a DC of 3 could be contacted by up to six enemy Shadowswords).

Q: Can a war engine counter charge if it has enemy units in base contact?

A: Nothing in 3.3 specifically overrides “Defending units that are not already in base contact with an enemy unit are allowed to counter charge,” from 1.12.4.

However, War Engines are allowed to barge as part of their counter charge, so it should be brought up in the five minute warm up. A suggested compromise is to mirror how a war engine loses its zone of control: so long as the number of units in base contact with a war engine is less than its starting damage capacity it may counter charge.

3.4 WAR ENGINE TRAINING SCENARIO

‘We’ve got our Gargantz an’ we’ve got our weapons. Wot ain’t we got? We ain’t got anyfing for target practice iz wot! So I’ll tell you wot we’re gonna do. We’re gonna give da Humies a taste of ‘ot metal death is wot. We’s gonna take Big Gork and Big Mork ‘ere an’ we’s gonna stomp Hummie!’

Warlord Dragnatz prepares the Boyz for the Waaagh!

The following training scenario will allow you to quickly and easily try out war engines for the first time. We highly recommend playing the scenario before including war engines in any normal games, as so many special rules apply to war engines that including them in a full sized game without any practice will slow things down to a crawl.

If you play Korps Grinda Returns twice, once as each side, then you will gain a good grasp of the war engine rules and will easily be able to incorporate them into the games that you play.

Note: The datasheets for this scenario are on the next page and in Section 5.0.

3.4 Gogard’s Last Stand

Warlord Gogard led an ill-advised invasion of the Imperial planet of Belle Alpha about ten years before the Battle For Armageddon. Trapped by Blood Angels Space Marine reinforcements, and with most of his boyz dead or dying, Gogard boarded his trusty Gargant *Korps Grinda* and set off for one last suicidal attack on the hated “beakies”. Gogard’s attack came as a complete surprise to the Blood Angels, who only managed to damage the Great Gargant before being forced to retreat from the awesome firepower of the war engine.

Gogard carried on until he reached the main Imperial defence line. Here the Imperial defenders were much better prepared and raked the Gargant with heavy weapons fire as it advanced. The Gargant crew struggled to contain the fires raging inside the war engine, and were able to do so just long enough to allow *Korps Grinda* to cause immense destruction to the defenders before a massive explosion in the hull destroyed the Gargant and Warlord Gogard once and for all.

Gogard’s last futile battle and glorious demise is a tale often retold around Ork campfires, with the result that a number of Ork Gargants on Armageddon are named *Korps Grinda* or a variation on the name (hey, nobody said that Orks were original!)

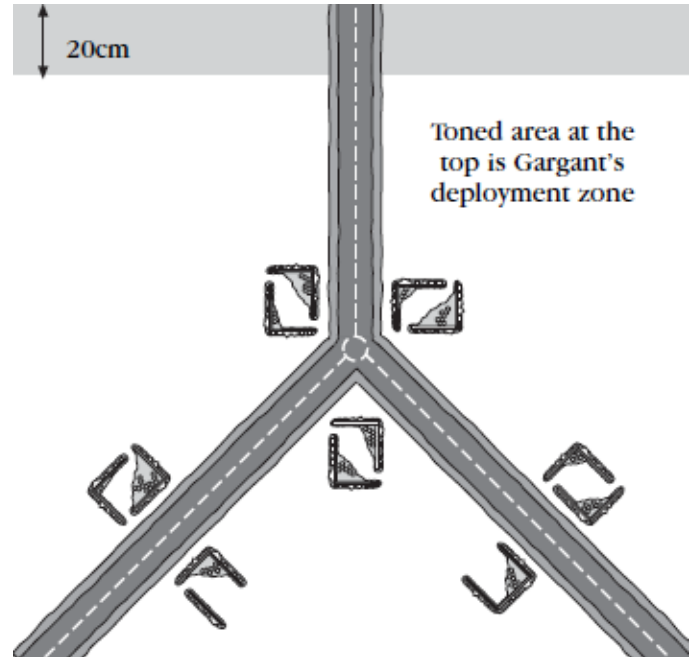
3.4.1 Korps Grinda Returns!

In a strange quirk of fate, one of the Gargants named *Korps Grinda II* found itself surrounded and cut off far behind Imperial lines, and was left with no option other than to try to inflict as much damage as possible before it was destroyed. The stage was set for a reprise of Gogard’s Last Stand!

Ork Forces: One formation consisting of *Korps Grinda II*, a Great Gargant (the datasheet is at the end of Section 5.5) The force has a strategy rating of 3 and all formations have an initiative value of 3+. The Mob Rule (see *Mob Rule*) and Power of the Waaagh (see *Power of the Waaagh!*) special rules apply to *Korps Grinda II*.

Space Marine Forces: One formation consisting of a Space Marine Commander, six Space Marine Tactical units and three Rhinos, plus one formation consisting of a Space Marine Commander and four Space Marine Devastator units, and one formation consisting of four Land Raiders. The force has a strategy rating of 5 and all formations have an initiative value of 1+. The “They Shall Know No Fear” special rule applies to all Space Marine formations (see 1.15.1).

Gaming Area: Set up the playing area approximately 90–120cm square, including the features shown on the accompanying map. Set up any further scenery you have in a mutually agreeable manner. The Space Marine player must set up two command bunkers when he deploys. These are the objectives of the Ork attack. They may be set up anywhere on the table that is at least 15cm from a table edge.



Deployment: The Space Marine player sets up first. One formation is deployed on the table, either in or touching the ruined buildings by the “Y” junction. The remaining two Space Marine formations enter play anywhere along the Space Marine table edge (including the roads) on the first turn of the battle. The Space Marine player must deploy one unit from each of these formations on the table edge to show where they will enter play. Their move on the first turn must be measured from this

point. Once the Space Marines have deployed, the Ork Great Gargant may be set up as shown on the deployment map.

Victory Conditions: The game carries on until *Korps Grinda II* is destroyed or both objectives have been demolished. If the Space Marines destroy *Korps Grinda II* without losing either bunker then they win the game. If one bunker is destroyed then the game is a draw, and if the Orks destroy both bunkers then they win.

NAME	TYPE	SPEED	ARMOUR	CC	FF	WEAPONS	RANGE	FIREPOWER
Command Bunker	WE	Immobile	4+	n/a	n/a	-		
NOTES: Damage Capacity 3. No units may enter the bunker as it is filled with comm’s gear.								

4.0 AEROSPACE OPERATIONS

“Krukfang pushed the control stick forward and steered Deffblasta down into a straffing run. The words of Gobstikk came back to him from when the Mekaniak had been teaching the young Krukfang how to fly. Long, uncontrolled bursts the clever Mek had taught him...”

“Fighta-Bommer” by Gav Thorpe, from Imperial Armour II

Most Epic armies are supported by aerial units that either operate in the atmosphere or from orbit in space. These units range from small fixed-wing aircraft with a single crewman, to gigantic spacecraft manned by thousands or even tens of thousands of crew. Aerospace units are very different to any other unit in Epic. They are very fast compared to the ground units described so far, being perfectly capable of flying onto and off the largest gaming table in a single turn. This sheer speed means that only specialised ground units or other aerospace units are capable of engaging them. In addition, aerospace units often carry an arsenal of highly destructive weapons which when combined with their high speed allows them to unleash devastating attacks at almost any point on the battlefield. Last, but not least, some aerospace units are capable of transporting ground units, hurtling onto the battlefield and delivering their cargo wherever they may be needed.

The rules for aerospace operations are one of the most complicated sections of the Epic rulebook. Because of this we recommend playing a few games without aerospace units before you try them out, and that you limit each side to very small numbers of aerospace units for the first few games that you do play with the rules. Diving in the deep end and using aircraft, drop pods and spacecraft in your first game is not recommended!

4.1 AEROSPACE UNITS

In Epic there are two types of aerospace unit:

Aircraft: The unit type includes all “fixed wing” aircraft that can operate in a planet’s atmosphere. Most aircraft are powered by powerful jet engines and are capable of carrying heavy payloads and of flying at thousands of kilometres an hour. Aircraft can range in size from small single-seat fighters to huge transport landers that can carry entire formations of troops. Aircraft belong to one of three manoeuvre classes that determine how easily they can turn when they move, as described below. The three classes are: *Fighters*, *Bombers*, and *Fighter-Bombers*. An aircraft’s manoeuvre class is noted instead of its speed on its data sheet.

Spacecraft: This category includes all of the interstellar spacecraft used by armies to move from one star system to another. These craft can vary in size from small escorts to huge battleships armed with enough firepower to level a hive city! In Epic they are assumed to be operating from low orbit where they can land drop pods and provide long-range support for ground troops.

4.1.1 Aerospace Formations

Aerospace units are organised into formations just like any other unit. However, although aerospace formations do receive Blast markers, they cannot be broken or suppressed. In addition, they can’t be assaulted, lend support to an assault or be used by another formation to claim a crossfire, etc., while in the air. Once landed, an aerospace unit may be assaulted and be used in a crossfire, and is affected by Blast markers normally.

4.2 AIRCRAFT⁶¹

Aircraft formations are not set-up with other units. They are kept off table (where it can be imagined they are in orbit or stationed at a nearby airbase) but can be set up on the board when they take an action. Aircraft that are capable of transporting other units may be set up with these units already on board. The aircraft (plus any units they are transporting) may only enter play using the following rules.

Aircraft formations can only take the following actions: Interception, Ground Attack, Combat Air Patrol or Stand Down. Aircraft formations that fail an action test must take a stand down action rather than a hold action.

Interception: Only fighters and fighter-bombers can choose this action. Take an action test for the formation and if it passes set up the formation touching your table edge. The formation may then make an approach move and then attack enemy aircraft units. In the end phase, the formation must make a disengagement move and exit the table.

Ground Attack: Take an action test for the formation and if it passes set up the formation touching your table edge. The formation may then make an approach move and then attack enemy ground units. In the end phase, the formation must make a disengagement move and exit the table.

Combat Air Patrol (CAP): Only fighters and fighter-bombers can choose this action. Take an action test for the formation and if it passes set up the formation touching your own side's table edge to show where it will enter play.

A formation on combat air patrol may choose to carry out an interception action in reaction to an enemy ground attack. No

initiative test is required to carry out the interception. It takes place after the enemy ground attack formation has made its approach move, but before flak is fired at the ground attackers or they make their own attack. Formations that are on CAP remain on CAP until they make an interception. If they haven't made an Interception by the end of the turn, then they can either stand down and return to base normally, or remain on CAP into the following turn.

No more than one formation that is on CAP may intercept a formation that makes a ground attack mission. In effect CAP allows you to interrupt an enemy ground attack action and "bounce" the enemy aircraft before they make their attack. The interception follows the normal rules, effectively being an "action within an action". After the interception has been carried out play returns to the ground attack action.

Stand Down: The formation may do nothing this turn. An aircraft formation that fails its action test *must* choose to take a stand down action.

4.2.1 Aircraft Approach Moves

Aircraft carrying out an interception or ground attack action are set up touching their own side's table edge (choose an edge randomly if your side doesn't have a table edge in the scenario being played). After the formation is set up it carries out an approach move.

Aircraft making an approach move may travel an unlimited distance over the tabletop when they move. Aircraft are assumed to be travelling high enough above the ground to fly over terrain, zones of control, and other units (in other words they ignore all three things!) By the same token, other units may ignore aircraft and aircraft zones of control when they move. Note that aircraft may not assault other units.

Aircraft must generally travel straight ahead in the direction they are facing, and can only change direction by *turning*. Aircraft belong to one of three manoeuvre classes that determine how easily they can turn when they move, as described below. The three classes are: Fighters, Bombers, and Fighter-Bombers. An aircraft's manoeuvre class is noted instead of its speed on its data sheet.

Fighters: Fighters may make one turn of up to 90° after moving at least 30cm. Once the fighter has made a turn it must move another 30cm before it can turn again.

Bombers: Bombers may make one turn of up to 45° after moving at least 30cm. Once the bomber has made a turn it must move another 30cm before it can turn again.

Fighter-Bombers: Fighter-bombers manoeuvre as bombers when making an approach move if they are carrying out a ground attack action (because they are laden down with bombs or rockets), and behave like fighters under any other circumstances.

61. Aircraft

Q: Can a formation on CAP choose to carry out an interception action in reaction to an enemy CAP interception?

A: No.

Q: What is the order of events with regards to aircraft/anti-aircraft/flak attacks, CAP and landing?

A: 1. An aircraft formation activates and makes an approach move.
 2. If the action taken was a ground attack an enemy aircraft formation on CAP may choose to carry out an interception action against it. If this occurs then the enemy aircraft formation makes an approach move and all flak attacks (from the aircraft formation, any friendly aircraft formations that are within range at the end of the enemy's approach move, and any friendly ground units with an AA value that were in range during the enemy's approach move) are resolved against it. Before rolling any saving throws it may choose to jink.
 3. All anti-aircraft and flak attacks (from any enemy aircraft formations that are within range at the end of the aircraft's approach move and any enemy ground units with an AA value that were in range during the aircraft's approach move) are resolved against the aircraft formation. Before rolling any saving throws it may choose to jink if it doesn't have the Bomber manoeuvre class.
 4. If the aircraft formation has a transport capacity and is carrying out a ground attack it may choose to land, at which point it becomes a ground unit. If any unit's disembark they and the aircraft formation may be subject to overwatch.
 5. The aircraft formation resolves its attacks or fights an assault if it decided to air assault.

4.2.2 Aircraft Attacks ⁶²

After aircraft have made their approach move they are allowed to attack. Aircraft carrying out a ground attack action may attack an enemy ground formation. Aircraft carrying out an interception mission may attack an enemy aircraft formation. Aircraft are assumed to be flying high enough in the air to ignore any terrain that might block the line of sight when they shoot at any targets, and the crossfire rule does not apply to aircraft attacks. This aside, resolve the attack using the normal shooting rules.

After the aircraft formation has made an attack, its action is over. It remains in play until the end phase, at which time it must make a disengagement move and exit the table (see 4.2.6).

4.2.3 Anti-aircraft Attacks ⁶³

Some weapons have an anti-aircraft value (AA) that can be used to attack aircraft, and only aircraft. Aircraft can shoot at other aircraft either when making a flak attack (see 4.2.4) or when attacking as part of an interception action. Ground units may *only* shoot at aircraft when making a flak attack, and may *not* choose to shoot at aircraft formations as part of one of their actions (this rule stops ground units “rushing over” to attack aircraft before they can disengage).

Roll to hit using the weapon’s AA value. If a hit is scored then the aircraft must make a saving roll to see if it is destroyed. The crossfire rule does not apply to aircraft. Aircraft that are carrying out a CAP or Intercept action may add +1 to all of their to hit rolls.

Fighters and fighter-bombers can choose to “jink” when they have to make a saving throw. Jinking represents the pilot desperately swerving his plane to one side in order to try and dodge the enemy attack. All of the aircraft in a formation must jink, or none at all. Aircraft that jink receive a 4+ saving throw instead of their normal armour save but lose their attack if they have not already taken it (they are concentrating on dodging enemy bullets). Place a suitable marker on the aircraft as a reminder it can’t shoot.

62. Aircraft Attacks

- Q: Can an aircraft end its approach move in the middle of an enemy formation in order to ensure a specific target is allocated hits before other models?
- A: No, if an aircraft ends its approach move in this manner then assume the fire is coming from the direction of the approach move.
- Q: Do aircraft that attack ground formations suffer to hit modifiers for cover?
- A: Only if the target is in cover, if the target is obscured then no because aircraft ignore anything that might block line of sight.

63. Anti-Aircraft Attacks

- Q: Can weapons with an AA value be used to attack landed aircraft?
- A: No.
- Q: Are jink saving throws invulnerable?
- A: No.

4.2.4 Flak Attacks ⁶⁴

AA weapons are designed to fire defensively against an attacking enemy aircraft, and may therefore shoot immediately after an enemy aircraft formation makes an approach move but before it makes its attack. This is called a *flak attack*. Note that aircraft carrying out a ground attack mission that are armed with AA weapons may shoot at enemy interceptors that fall within the AA weapon’s fire arc. Making a flak attack does not remove overwatch status from a ground formation.

Flak attacks may not be carried out by units belonging to a formation that is marching or broken. This aside, flak attacks are a “free” or bonus attack, and making a flak attack does not stop the unit attacking again later in the same turn. What’s more, a flak weapon can make any number of flak attacks per turn against different aircraft formations, as long as it does not attack the same aircraft formation more than once in a turn. Flak units in formations which have taken a move action during the turn fire with a -1 to-hit modifier during the end phase.

No line of fire is required when firing at aircraft, as it is assumed that they are high enough above any terrain features to be seen by all units. Make flak attacks one unit at a time, in any order you like.

Ground units that are armed with AA weapons can shoot at enemy aircraft as they move past them. To represent this, they may shoot at an aircraft formation that moved within their weapon range during their approach or disengagement move, even if the aircraft is no longer within weapon range when the attack is made. Attacks made against disengaging aircraft are resolved when the aircraft reaches the edge of the table, before it is removed to “fly back to base”. Units that shot at an aircraft formation as it approached may not shoot at them again as they disengage.

64. Flak Attacks

- Q: Can units with weapons that don’t have an AA value be suppressed when making a flak attack?
- A: Yes, and they only need to be within range as all ground units have a line of fire to flying aircraft.
- Q: Do to hit modifiers for a double, marshal or sustain action apply to flak attacks?
- A: No, the only modifier that does is the -1 to hit during the end phase if the unit’s formation carried out any action that involved a move.
- Q: An aircraft makes its approach move and suffers flak attacks from one unit in a formation. As it makes its disengagement move it comes into range of another unit from the same formation, may this unit flak attack the aircraft?
- A: Yes, each unit may only shoot at an aircraft once per turn.

4.2.5 Transporting Ground Units ⁶⁵

Aircraft with a transport capacity are known as transport aircraft and are allowed to pick up and drop off ground units. Troops being transported are kept off-board embarked on the transport aircraft until it is deployed. Any units that are picked up and transported off the table may later return to play in the same transport aircraft.

An aircraft must carry out a ground attack action in order to transport units. Transport aircraft are treated in the same manner as war engine transport vehicles, and are only allowed to transport units from another formation as long as the whole formation can fit inside the transport aircraft (see 3.1.3). If a transport aircraft is destroyed while carrying ground units, then any transported troops are lost with it (no saves in this case!)

Transport aircraft can pick up and drop off their cargo in two ways: by landing or making an air assault.

Landing: Aircraft with a transport capability can land after making their approach move and having being fired upon by any enemy flak. If the aircraft lands in dangerous terrain it must take a dangerous terrain test. After the aircraft has landed, any units being transported may disembark and are placed within 5cms of the transport aircraft (skimmers and units with jump packs can be placed within 15cms, to represent them dropping from the aircraft as it comes in to land). Alternatively, the aircraft may pick up any friendly units within 5cms, assuming they will fit on board of course. After embarking or disembarking any units, the aircraft may carry out its ground attack. Note that the limitations that apply to units disembarking from a war engine transport vehicle also apply to units disembarking from an aircraft (i.e., they can't take an action on the turn they disembark but can shoot with the aircraft—see 3.1.3).

Once landed, the aircraft is treated in all ways as a ground unit with a speed of 0 (i.e., it may not move) It may not carry out an action on the turn it lands. If it is involved in an assault and loses then it is automatically destroyed. Once landed, the aircraft may make a disengagement move and exit the table in the end phase of any turn, including the one it landed in.

Air Assault: Transport aircraft may choose to land as described

above, and then it and any units that disembark are allowed to fight an assault instead of shooting. If this option is chosen then the aircraft and any units that disembark may enter enemy zones of control as if they were charging. The aircraft and any units that disembark are treated as a single formation for the duration of the assault, in the same manner as units disembarking from a war engine taking an engage action (see 3.1.3). If the aircraft loses the assault it is destroyed, but any units that have disembarked may withdraw normally.

4.2.6 Disengagement Moves ⁶⁶

In the end phase, all aircraft that have not landed must exit the table. Aircraft that have landed may choose to exit the table. Aircraft may exit along ANY table edge. Simply move the aircraft as you did when it made its approach move, until it reaches a table edge. This is called the *disengagement move*, and it takes place at the start of the end phase before any ground formations rally.

65. Transporting Ground Units

Q: Can aircraft without a transport capacity land?

A: No.

Q: If a landed aircraft is destroyed while carry ground units, are they lost with it?

A: No, resolve this as per 1.7.5.

Q: Can units that have a special ability that allows them to enter play use it if a aircraft transports them off board?

A: No, they may only enter play again via disembarking from the landed aircraft.

Q: Can a transport aircraft jink and still carry out an air assault.

A: Yes, so long as it doesn't have the Bomber manoeuvre class.

Q: Is it possible to air assault into a formation which is completely covered by the zone of control of another formation?

A: You can play it either way, just bring it up in the five minute warm up.

Q: Is a fearless aircraft that loses an assault automatically destroyed?

A: No.

Q: Can a unit use its consolidation move to get into an aircraft?

A: Yes, but the aircraft may not make a disengagement move.

66. Disengagement Moves

Q: If an aircraft has traveled more than 30cm during its approach move and didn't end it with a turn can it turn immediately when it makes a disengagement move?

A: No, it still must move at least another 30cm before it is allowed to turn.

Q: What happens when a landed aircraft does not make a disengagement move?

A: It rallies in the end phase like a ground formation and has the potential to activate like a ground formation next turn.

4.2.7 Blast Markers⁶⁷

Aircraft collect Blast markers in a similar manner to other units, but are affected by them rather differently. The following fairly simple rules reflect the time it takes to rearm and refuel aircraft after a mission. Aircraft in a formation that has come under heavy attack and therefore have a lot of Blast markers will take longer to get ready, and so there is an increased chance that they may not get to carry out a mission.

Aircraft formations collect Blast markers under the following circumstances:

- Any aircraft formation that suffers any attacks (from ground flak or being intercepted) receives one Blast marker for “coming under fire”. The formation can only receive one Blast marker during the approach move and another Blast marker during the disengagement move, no matter how many different units from however many different formations attack it.
- The aircraft receives one Blast marker for each aircraft unit that is shot down or point of damage that is suffered if it is a war engine.
- The aircraft receives an extra Blast marker if it exits from any table edge other than its own table edge, to represent the possibility of it being attacked while flying back over enemy territory.

Aircraft are not suppressed or broken by Blast markers, but are not allowed to rally in the end phase either. Instead, the next time that you want to take an action with the formation, take the action test as before, but apply a -1 modifier for each Blast marker on the formation (this modifier replaces the modifier for having one or more Blast markers).

All of the Blast markers are removed from the formation immediately after it takes the action test, whether it passes the test or not. If it passes the test, it may carry out an action, and if it fails it may not.

Aircraft that land are affected by any Blast markers they have picked up normally, and are allowed to rally in the end phase. Any additional Blast markers they pick up will be “carried off” with them if they later take off again.

4.3 SPACECRAFT

Most armies have access to spacecraft that can be used to land ballistic entry vehicles and unleash potentially devastating orbital attacks. Each type of spacecraft an army can use has its own datasheet with details of the drop pods and weapons carried by the spacecraft.

The spacecraft of the 41st Millennium are huge. Even a small Imperial Lunar class Cruiser would be over 5 metres long if we made an Epic scale model of it. Because of this neither side is allowed to include more than one spacecraft in their army.

Spacecraft can carry out orbital bombardments, pin-point attacks and land units with the planetfall ability when they take an action. They may carry out all three of these things as part of the same action if they have the ability—their huge crew allows them to carry out a multitude of tasks.

4.3.1 Planning Spacecraft Operations⁶⁸

In order to carry out spacecraft operations you will need a Battlefleet Gothic model representing the orbiting spacecraft.

Spacecraft operations must be planned well in advance, and because of this any spacecraft models must be set up right at the start of the battle before any ground units are deployed. If both players have spacecraft, they should take turns in setting them up, starting with the player with the higher strategy rating.

Spacecraft are set up touching their own side’s table edge (choose an edge randomly if your side doesn’t have a table edge in the scenario being played), facing in any direction. As each spacecraft is set up, the player must declare out loud on which turn the ship will arrive. Note that the turn the spacecraft will arrive is not a secret—they are far too large to sneak up on the enemy! You may choose any turn, from the first turn onwards. However, you may not choose a turn that has already been taken by another spacecraft, and no more than one spacecraft can travel over the battlefield on the same turn.

In addition to saying when the spacecraft will arrive, you must secretly record the drop zone for units entering play using the planetfall ability, (see 4.4) and also where any orbital bombardments will fall. Each player needs to do this in turn while the other player is not looking.

Simply write down on a piece of paper the coordinates of the drop zone and/or bombardment in relation to the position of the space craft model. The coordinates you plot will determine the centre point of the drop zone and any orbital bombardment your spacecraft fires. For example you might write “my drop zone will be 60cm up, 30cm right, and my orbital bombardment will come down 45cm up and 30cm left”. This would mean that the drop zone would be located 60cm up and 30cm to the right of the spacecraft model, while the orbital bombardment would hit a point 45cm and 30cm to the left of the model.

4.3.2 Carrying Out The Operation⁶⁹

Spacecraft operations take place in the action phase of the turn.

67. Blast Markers

Q: Do aircraft get a Blast marker for failing an activation?

A: No.

68. Planning Spacecraft Operations

Q: Do all units with planetfall have to have the same drop zone?

A: No, you just need one drop zone for each formation entering play via planetfall.

Simply take an action test for the spacecraft as you would for any other formation. If the test is passed, the spacecraft may make orbital bombardments, pin-point attacks, and carry out a planetfall as described in the sections that follow (see 4.3.3, 4.3.4 and 4.4).

After any attacks or landings have taken place, the spacecraft model is removed. If the test is failed then the spacecraft has been delayed and fails to arrive this turn; you may roll for it again next turn as long as no other spacecraft are scheduled to arrive that turn. If the next turn has been taken, then the delayed spacecraft will arrive in the first available free turn.

4.3.3 Orbital Bombardments⁷⁰

If a spacecraft can carry out an orbital bombardment this will be noted on its datasheet.

Orbital bombardments cover an area considerably larger than an artillery bombardment, and so require a barrage template that is 12cm across. By a remarkable stroke of good fortune this happens to be the same size as the Ordnance template used in Warhammer 40,000, and if you happen to have any of these we recommend you use them (I know, it's almost like we planned it, isn't it) If not then make your own templates from card or acetate.

Take one of the templates and place it with its centre at the coordinates you recorded at the start of the battle. Note that you don't need to pass a second initiative test in order to carry out the bombardment—the one you passed earlier on allows the bombardment to take place.

Once the position of the orbital bombardment is known, attack any units under the templates just as you would for an artillery barrage (see 1.9.8). Orbital bombardments never benefit from the crossfire rule.

4.3.4 Pin-Point Attacks⁷¹

Pin-point attacks may be made on enemy war engines (war engines are the only things big enough for a spacecraft to pick out on the battlefield). Pick a target anywhere on the table and then attack it with any pin-point attacks the spacecraft may have. You may target different war engines with each pin-point attack if you wish, or concentrate all of the attacks on a single target. Note that you do not need to record the co-ordinates of pin-point attacks.

69. Carrying Out The Operation

Q: What is the order of events with regards to a spacecraft's operation.

- A: 1. The spacecraft resolves all of its orbital bombardment and pin-point attacks, assuming an action test is passed.
2. Each formation entering play via planetfall is resolved (placing and then scattering it, and then resolving any special abilities like those on a Space Marine Drop Pod). These can be in any order the player controlling the spacecraft desires.
3. Check to see if any formations that were subject to orbital bombardment, pin-point attacks or special abilities are broken.

70. Orbital Bombardments

Q: Do all formations that are under an orbital bombardment template receive a Blast marker for coming under fire?

A: Yes.

Q: Are there any restrictions for placing extra orbital bombardment templates?

A: No.

71. Pin-Point Attacks

Q: If a spacecraft has multiple pin-point attacks and uses them to attack separate formations do they each get a Blast marker for coming under fire?

A: Yes.

Q: If a formation contains multiple war engines who picks the target of a pin-point attack?

A: The attacker. Tell your Commissars to stop opening hatches and waving swords around, they can be seen from space.

4.4 PLANETFALL⁷²

Some armies are allowed to land ground units from orbiting spacecraft in specially modified vehicles. These vehicles are mainly used to carry troops from orbiting spacecraft to the planet below. Most are more like manned missiles than aircraft, and are designed to be fired at extremely high speeds into the planet's atmosphere. At the last moment, powerful jets slow the descent of the vehicle allowing it and its cargo to land safely on the planet's surface. The high speeds that the vehicles travel at makes it almost impossible for weapons to engage them before they have landed. This is known as making a *planetfall*.

Any unit capable of making a planetfall will have this noted on its datasheet. The datasheets for a spacecraft will note the type and number of units it may carry that can make planetfall. It is assumed that a spacecraft can also carry any cargo that will be transported in the unit with the planetfall ability. Units entering play by planetfall and their cargo (if any) should be kept off the table until they have landed.

You can make a planetfall on the turn the spacecraft transporting the units enters play. Carry out the planetfall after carrying out any bombardments and/or pin-point attacks. Take one of the units with the planetfall ability and place it anywhere on the table that is within 15cms of the drop zone co-ordinates recorded at the start of the game (see 4.3.1). The unit then scatters 2D6cms in a random direction (we recommend using a Games Workshop scatter dice to determine the direction, but any mutually agreeable method will do). Any units being transported are allowed to disembark immediately on landing, or stay on board and disembark later. Landing does not count as movement for the purposes of triggering enemy overwatch fire. Disembarking triggers overwatch fire as normal.

Carry on doing this until all of the units with the planetfall ability that are on the spacecraft have landed. Units that end up out of formation due to scattering as they land must move back into a legal formation when they next take an action (see 1.2.1 and 1.6.1).

Units entering play by planetfall are destroyed if they land off the table. If the unit lands on terrain that is impassable or dangerous for it, or on top of any sort of unit (friend or foe), or in an enemy zone of control, then it is assumed that on-board automatic guidance systems will divert it towards a safe landing point and the unit is moved by the opposing player to the nearest area of clear ground where it can land.

Units that land by planetfall may take an action later in the turn. In effect the units land from the spacecraft when the spacecraft takes its action, and can take an action of their own later in the same turn. Remember that any formations that have landed by planetfall and scattered out of formation must move back into a

legal formation when they take an action. Aircraft that land by planetfall are treated in the same manner as a landed aircraft (see 4.2.5), and they may take off again later in the game.

72. Planetfall

Q: Can flak attacks be made against an aircraft enter play via planetfall?

A: No.

Q: What happens when the “nearest area of clear ground” isn't big enough to deploy an entire formation entering play via planetfall?

A: The opposing player moves it to the nearest area of clear ground where the entire formation can deploy.

4.5 AEROSPACE TRAINING SCENARIOS

“Today had been a good day for Krukfang; plenty of firing, plenty of speed.”

The rules for aerospace operations, like the war engine rules that preceded them, are fairly long and complex, and for this reason it is best to learn how to use them by playing the following training scenarios before you use them in full-sized games. The training scenarios concentrate on the aircraft rules exclusively, as these are both the most complex and the most commonly used.

Note: The datasheets for these two scenarios are on the next page and in Section 5.0.

4.5.1 Death From The Skies!

In the sulphur-yellow skies above Armageddon, Ork fighta-bombers battle with Imperial Navy Thunderbolts and Marauders in a deadly dance of death. Typical of these engagements was the Ork aerial attack on Imperial Command Bunker Complex 17c, home to the Headquarters of the Imperial Guard 2nd Asgardian Rangers regiment. More than half a dozen Ork fighta-bombers from Harthag’s Deffblasta’s Flyboyz Squadron attacked the complex, and were intercepted by elements of the Imperial Navy’s 222nd Interceptor Strike Wing. The air combat that unfolded is considered by many to be one of the classic aerial engagements of the Armageddon wars.

Ork Forces: Two formations each consisting of four Ork Fighta-Bombers. The force has a strategy rating of 3 and all formations have an initiative value of 3+.

Imperial Forces: One formation consisting of three Imperial Navy Thunderbolt Fighters, plus two formations each consisting of one Command Bunker and one Hydra AA vehicle, and one formation consisting of three Basilisk artillery vehicles and one Hydra. The force has a strategy rating of 2 and all formations have an initiative value of 2+.

Gaming Area: Set up a playing area approximately 90–120cm square. Set up any scenery you have in a mutually agreeable manner. You can set up as much or as little scenery as you like, but try to make sure that you have at least a couple of hills and either a built-up area or some woods for the troops to hide behind or take cover in.

Deployment: The Imperial player sets up first, and must set up all of the ground formations in his force anywhere he likes on the table. Both sides’ aircraft are off the table at the start of the battle.

Special Rules: See *Power of the Waaagh!* for *Power of the Waaagh!*

Victory Conditions: The Ork player has three turns in which to destroy both Command Bunkers and all three Basilisks. If he succeeds he wins, if not the Imperial player wins.

4.5.2 Thunderhawk Down

Acheron Hive fell without warning on the fifth day of the invasion of Armageddon, the victim of treachery by none other than ex-Imperial Governor Herman von Strab. Intelligence reports indicated that von Strab was located in a captured

command bunker just outside the hive city. A small force of Terminators from the Salamanders Chapter were despatched in a Thunderhawk Gunship in a bid to capture the traitor. The Terminators landed just outside the bunkers and quickly overran the complex, but found that von Strab had already left. Things started to go wrong when Ork Fighta-Bombers ambushed the Thunderhawk sent to evacuate the Terminators. Only the Thunderhawk’s legendarily sturdy construction and the timely assistance of some Imperial Navy Thunderbolt fighters allowed it to survive and pick up the Terminators. When the Thunderhawk returned to base only one engine was still functioning, all of its crew had either been wounded or killed, and bullet holes caused by over 250 big shoota shell hits were counted on its hull. All of the Terminators sent on the mission were evacuated safely.

Imperial Forces: One Thunderhawk Gunship, plus one formation consisting of four Space Marine Terminator units, and one formation consisting of three Imperial Navy Thunderbolt fighters. The force has a strategy rating of 5. All Space Marine formations have an initiative value of 1+, and the Thunderbolts have an initiative value of 2+.

Ork Forces: Two formations each consisting of three Ork Fighta-Bombers, and two formations each consisting of one Command Bunker and one (traitor) Imperial Guard Hydra AA vehicle. The force has a strategy rating of 2. Traitor Guard formations have an initiative value of 2+, and the Ork Fighta-Bommerz have an initiative value of 3+.

Gaming Area: Same as 4.5.1.

Deployment: The Ork player sets up first, and must set up all of the ground formations in his force anywhere he likes on the table. All remaining formations are off the table at the start of the battle. The Space Marine player may teleport the Terminators into battle if he wishes to (see 2.1.17).

Special Rules: See *Power of the Waaagh!* for *Power of the Waaagh!* and *They Shall Know No Fear* for *They Shall Know No Fear*.

Victory Conditions: The Imperial player wins if he destroys both bunkers with close combat attacks, and then manages to exit at least one Terminator unit off the table in a Thunderhawk Gunship. The Imperial player gets a draw if he destroys both bunkers. Any other result is a win for the Ork player.

NAME	TYPE	SPEED	ARMOUR	CC	FF	WEAPONS	RANGE	FIREPOWER
Command Bunker	WE	Immobile	4+	n/a	n/a	-		

NOTES: Damage Capacity 3. No units may enter the bunker as it is filled with comm’s gear.

5.0 FORCES

This section of the Epic rules includes datasheets for each of the armies, plus a reference sheet that groups all of the game tables together into one place. The following abbreviations are used on the datasheets:

Abbreviations

AC: Aircraft	FS: First Strike	MW: Macro-weapon
AV: Armoured Vehicle	FwA: Forward Fire Arc	Right: Right Fire Arc
(bc): (base contact)	FxF: Fixed Forward Fire Arc	RrA: Rear Fire Arc
BP: Barrage Points	GM: Guided Missile	S: Sniper
CC: Close Combat	IC: Ignore Cover	SC: Spacecraft
CH: Character	Ind: Indirect Fire	Slw: Slow Firing
D: Disrupt	INF: Infantry	SS: Single Shot
DC: Damage Capacity	L: Lance	TK(x): Titan Killer (x)
EA(+x): Extra Attacks (+x)	Left: Left Fire Arc	WE: War Engine
FF: Firefight	LV: Light Vehicle	WM: Weapon Mount

5.0.1 EPIC ARMAGEDDON REFERENCE SHEET

Blast Marker Table

<i>Blast Markers</i>	<i>Result</i>	<i>Effect</i>
Each Blast Marker	Unit <i>Suppressed</i>	May not shoot
One per unit	Formation <i>Broken</i>	Withdraw

Actions

Advance: Make one move and then shoot.

Engage: Make one “charge” move and then fight an assault.

Double: Make two moves and then shoot with a -1 modifier.

March: Make three moves.

Marshal: Shoot with a -1 modifier and then regroup, or make one move and then regroup.

Overwatch: Enter overwatch.

Sustained Fire: Shoot with a +1 modifier.

Hold: Make one move or shoot or regroup.

Action Test Table (Cumulative)

Formation has at least one Blast marker	-1
Formation is trying to retain the initiative	-1

To Hit Modifier Table (Cumulative)

Target is in cover	-1
Attacker is carrying out a double or marshal action	-1
Attacker is carrying out a sustained fire action	+1

Needing 7+ to Hit

<i>Target</i>	<i>D6 rolls needed</i>
7	6 followed by 4, 5 or 6
8	6 followed by 5 or 6
9	6 followed by 6
10	May not be hit

Assault Modifiers (Cumulative)

For each kill you have inflicted	+1
You have more units	+1
You have more than twice as many units	+1
Your formation has no Blast markers	+1
The opposing formation has more Blast markers	+1
For each unit with <i>Inspiring</i>	+1

Rally Test Modifiers (Cumulative)

Formation is broken	-2
There are enemy units within 30cms	-1

Victory Conditions Summary

Blitz: Capture the objective on your opponent’s board edge

BTS: Destroy the enemy formation worth the most points

DTF: Control all three objectives in your table half

T&H: Capture two objectives in your opponent’s table half

TSNP: No unbroken enemy formations in your table half

Barrage Table

<i>Barrage Points</i>	<i>Extra Templates</i>	<i>Extra Blast Markers</i>	<i>To Hit Rolls</i>	
			<i>AP</i>	<i>AT</i>
1	None	None	6+	6+
2	None	None	5+	6+
3	None	None	4+	5+
4–5	One	None	4+	5+
6–7	One	One	4+	5+
8–9	Two	One	4+	5+
10–12	Two	Two	4+	5+
13–15	Two	Three	4+	5+
16–18	Two	Four	4+	5+

Terrain Effects Table

<i>Terrain</i>	<i>Infantry</i>	<i>Vehicle</i>	<i>War Engine</i>
Buildings	4+ Cover Save	Impassable	Impassable
Cliffs	Impassable	Impassable	Impassable
Fortifications	3+ Cover Save, See rules	See rules	Impassable
Jungle	4+ Cover Save	Impassable	Dangerous
Marsh	6+ Cover Save, Dangerous	Dangerous	Dangerous
Open Ground, Hill Slopes	No Effect	No Effect	No Effect
River	6+ Cover Save, Dangerous	Impassable	No Effect
Roads	See rules	See rules	See rules
Ruins, Rubble	4+ Cover Save	Dangerous	Dangerous
Scrub	6+ Cover Save	No Effect	No Effect
Woods	5+ Cover Save	Dangerous	Dangerous

6.0 EPIC GAMING

“Myriad are the ways of war. The lightning strike, the tenacious defence, the cunning ruse; all have their time and place, oft as not dictated by the lie of the land or balance of forces that you find at your disposal. The art of war is learning how to bind the tactics, terrain and forces at your command to your advantage.”

Imperium Tactica

Tournament games are the single most popular form of Epic game. This is mainly because it is the easiest way to play Epic. All you have to do is use the army lists to collect an army, safe in the knowledge that you can use it to play an even and balanced game even against a complete stranger, something that is simply not possible with scenarios or campaigns. In order to achieve this happy state of affairs, tournament games require three things: *army lists*, *points values*, and a set of *tournament game rules*.

An army list, as its name implies, is a list of units and formations that can be used by an army. What sets it apart from a simple order of battle, such as the forces included in the training scenarios presented earlier in this rulebook, is that it is a list of things you *can* use in your army rather than a list of things you *must* use. So, for example, a Space Marine army list would say something along the lines of: “You may have the following things in your army: Space Marine Tactical detachments, Space Marine Assault detachments, Space Marine Terminator detachments...” and so on. Army lists usually focus on one army, for example Space Marines, or Imperial Guard, or Orks, though some cover combined or allied forces. In addition, army lists can either be “generic” and cover all armies of that type, or “specific” and cover a particular army or famous regiment. For example, a generic Space Marine army list would allow you to collect any Chapter, while a Blood Angels army list would only allow Blood Angel units to be used. The advantage of specific lists is that they can include more interesting and characterful units, while a generic list lacks this level of detail but gives the player more freedom in terms of painting and modelling.

Of course, if players were simply allowed to pick any units or formations they liked from an army list then there is no way that tournament games could be fair—the player with the largest collection of models would always have a big advantage! Because of this, each formation and unit in an army list is given a points value. The points value shows how effective the unit or formation is when it is used in a tournament game. So, for example, a mighty Baneblade tank would cost many more points than a humble Leman Russ, as the Baneblade will have a much greater impact on the course of the game. Players are then given the freedom to choose troops from their army list to a set points value. For example, players might agree to play a 2,000 point game, in which case each could pick troops worth 2,000 points from their own army list. As long as the army lists have been worked out properly, then any two armies with the same points value will have an equal chance of winning, although the actual composition of each army may be radically different, even if both are chosen from the same list. Returning to our prior example, one player might choose to take a few Baneblades, while his opponent chooses to take a horde of Leman Russ, but as long as the points values for the two units have been worked out

properly then each player will have the same chance of winning the game.

The final piece of the jigsaw is the tournament game rules. In order to create a fair and balanced contest, tournament games need to have a method of setting up the terrain, deploying the armies, and determining the winner that is as even as possible for both sides. These are known as the tournament game rules, and they need to be set out in advance along with the army lists, so that a player can choose his army knowing what sort of battle he will be fighting. Because of the desire to create an even contest, tournament game rules tend to be quite simple. Terrain will usually be kept to a minimum and not include too many exotic features, and both armies will usually deploy in a “set-up zone” near their own table edge. Victory conditions can be quite complex, but will almost always be the same for both sides (a process called “mirroring”). A very common set of tournament game victory conditions is to play for a certain number of turns, and then for each player to count up the points value of destroyed enemy units to see who has won. A variation on this theme is for each player to place a certain number of “objective markers” in the opposing half of the table, with the winner being the player that has captured the most objectives at the end of the game. Previous versions of Epic have used a combination of these two methods, with players winning points for destroying the enemy and capturing objectives, to determine the winner. However, whatever rules are actually used, the aim is always to create as even a contest as possible between the two armies picked from the army lists, and this usually leads to fairly straight-forward “line up and fight” battles with a minimum of terrain and mirrored victory conditions for both sides.

The overall effect of this is to create a game that is ideal for “pick-up” games between two players that have not met each other before. Tournament games allow the player to simply go ahead and collect an army, choosing whichever models they like within the constraints of the army list, and then turn up at a club or gaming event, find an opponent, and play knowing that the game will be as fair and even as possible.

6.1 EPIC TOURNAMENT GAME RULES

The Epic tournament game rules are designed to be used in conjunction with the Epic tournament army lists. They will allow two players to fight an evenly balanced battle with little or no preparation. They are ideal for pick-up games at clubs or shows, and provide an evenly balanced contest in tournaments.

In many ways, tournament games represent the most “basic” form of game play, and are designed to be as easy and accessible as possible in order to allow Epic players to play games with the minimum of fuss. Because of this, the tournament rules require little or no preparation other than picking forces from the army lists, while the army lists are designed to work with the packaged range of Epic miniatures produced by Games Workshop, making it easy for players to put together an army. Later sections include rather more advanced rules and guidelines that will allow experienced players to design their own unique formations and units for use in scenarios or campaigns of their own devising.

6.1.1 Forces

Both players pick armies to an agreed points total between 2,000 to 5,000 points using the tournament army lists. It is possible to play games using the tournament rules for larger or smaller games than this, but please note that the army lists have been balanced assuming that armies will fall within this range, and this means that larger or smaller games may be slightly unbalanced.

6.1.2 Set-up

Set up the terrain for the game in any mutually agreeable manner. If one player sets up the terrain then his opponent may choose where to deploy. If you set up the terrain as a joint effort or it was set up by a tournament organiser then the player with the higher strategy rating may choose the table edge he sets up on. If both players have the same strategy rating, then dice to see who gets the choice of table edge. You can pick a long edge, or a corner (half way up each long and short edge). The opponent sets up on the opposite edge or corner.

The tournament game rules have been designed to be played on tables that are 90–150cm wide by 150–240cm long (that’s 3–5 feet by 5–8 feet for you non-metric types!) The ideal size is round-about 120cm by 180cm (4 feet by 6 feet). It is possible to play games on tables that are wider or longer than this, but this may favour certain armies and could lead to an unbalanced game.

6.1.3 The Five Minute Warm Up⁷³

Tabletop miniatures wargaming is not an exact science. One person’s line of sight is another’s blocked line of fire, some people love pre-measuring, others hate it, and so on. Because of this after you have set up the terrain for a game you should spend five minutes going through things like how the line of fire rules will work, how the terrain features used will work, and so on. Here are some of the things you may want to discuss:

- The “Counts As” Rule (see 6.2.1).
- Lines of Sight and Lines Of Fire.
- Fire Arcs on units.
- Pre-measuring.
- Templates and if units are “in or out”.
- Terrain features—what do they count as on the terrain chart, when are units “in” terrain.
- How you will show if a formation is broken, in overwatch or has marched this turn.
- Anything else you can think of!

73. The Five Minute Warm Up

Q: Is there a complete list of what to cover in the five minute warm up?

- A:
- Should you dice for each ability used at the start of the turn?
 - Are transported units considered to be in specific transporting units of their formation?
 - When disembarking, are transported units placed completely within 5cm of the transport unit or just so one part of the transported unit is within 5cm of the transport unit?
 - When does a unit count as being in cover?
 - How many units can claim cover from a armoured vehicle, war engine, or terrain feature?
 - Does the charging formation need to get within 15cm of the original target or can it get within 15cm of any intermingled formation?
 - How are attacks with special abilities like ignore cover and lance allocated in an assault?
 - Can a war engine counter charge if it has enemy units in base contact?
 - Is it possible to air assault into a formation which is completely covered by the zone of control of another formation?
 - Where should measurements for capturing/contesting an objective be made from?
 - What house rules do you normally play with?
 - Are you using the “counts as” rule?
 - What is your army capable of (units, weapons and special rules)?

6.1.4 Place Objective Markers⁷⁴

Take it in turns, starting with the player with the higher strategy rating, to place one objective marker on the table. If both players have the same strategy rating then dice to see who places the first objective marker.

The first objective a player sets up must be placed on their own table edge. The remaining two objectives must be set up in their opponent's half of the table, at least 30cm away from the opponent's table edge and 30cm away from any other objectives that have already been placed.

Keep placing objectives until six objective markers have been placed on the table in total. You can use anything as an objective marker but we would suggest using terrain pieces to represent them if you can. In our games, we've found that battling over an actual bunker or fuel dump is far more appealing than having your forces sell their lives for a cardboard counter!

You capture an objective if you have a unit within 15cms of it in

the end phase and your opponent does not. An objective is contested if both sides have a unit within 15cms of it in the end phase. Units from broken formations or from formations that have rallied that end phase can not capture or contest objectives. Aircraft which have landed may not capture an objective on the same turn that it lands. However, a landed aircraft may immediately contest an objective.

Check at the end of each turn to see how many objectives you control. Objectives do not have a "memory" and you will lose control of any you have captured if there are no friendly units within 15cms of them at the end of any subsequent turn.

74. Place Objective Markers

Q: Can the player with the higher strategy rating choose to make their opponent place first?

A: No.

Q: How big can objective markers be?

A: As big as you like, just remember that they're a marker and as such don't count as terrain or block a line of fire.

Q: Where should measurements for capturing/contesting an objective be made from?

A: This should be brought up during five minute warp up. For objectives placed on a table edge, most groups measure to the center of the area that touches the table edge, while all other objectives are measured from their center or a designated point.

DESIGN CONCEPT

Tournament Terrain

The tournament game rules will work on any type of terrain. However, especially dense or extremely sparse terrain will favour some armies or troop choices over others. An Ork army with a lot of Boyz will do well on a table covered with lots of terrain, for example, while an Ork army with lots of buggies and gunwagons will do better on a table with sparse terrain. In addition, certain terrain features can favour one army over another. Having a river running the length of the table will favour an army with a lot of skimmers and aircraft. You get the idea, I'm sure.

Because of this, we recommend you use the following guidelines when setting up terrain for tournament games. These are not a set of hard and fast rules, but if they are used will ensure a well-balanced game no matter what army or units are taken.

- We recommend the use of terrain features when playing tournament games in preference to modular terrain (see the Appendices for a more detailed description of the two types of terrain).
- Terrain features can be of pretty much any type, but should be roughly 15–30cm across. Hills can be up to twice this size. See below for a note of how to deal with rivers and roads.
- Divide the table into 60cm (2 foot) square areas. The total number of terrain features placed should be equal to twice the number of 60cm square areas. For example, if you were playing on a 120cm by 180 cm, you would have six areas and should place 12 terrain features.
- Within the limits above, place between 0–4 features in each 60cm square.
- The terrain may include one river. Rivers count as a terrain feature for each area that they run through. They need to enter on one table edge and leave from another, and should not be greater in length than the shortest table edge. For example, on a 120cm by 180cm table, the river should not be more than 120cm long. There should be a bridge or ford every 30cm along the river.
- Roads may be added after all terrain features have been placed. Any number of roads may be used. They need to enter on one table edge and either exit from another or end at a terrain feature.

6.1.5 Setup Spacecraft & Garrisons⁷⁵

If either player is using spacecraft then they are set up now before any other units (see 4.3). Units entering play via planetfall should be placed to one side at this time too (see 4.4).

On-table garrison units are set up after spacecraft have been set up. The following types of formations may be set up on the table as “garrisons” at the start of the game:

- Formations where half or more of the units (rounding up) are scouts OR
- Formations where no more than one of the units has a move greater than 15cms, and where none of the units are war engines OR
- Any formations that include units with a speed of 0 (zero).

Players take it in turns to set up one garrison at a time, starting with the player with the higher strategy rating. Garrisons must be set up so that they have at least one unit within 15cm of an objective in the player’s own half of the table. No units may be set up in the opponent’s half of the table or in impassable terrain. Units may be set up in dangerous terrain (it’s assumed that they took their time getting into position in order to do so safely!)

Each player may start up to two of their garrisoned formations on Overwatch. These formations represent sentries deployed as a trip wire and to provide security at the objectives. They are assumed to have gone on Overwatch in their previous Action phase. That Overwatch is “carried over” into the first turn.

6.1.6 Set-up Remaining Formations⁷⁶

All of the remaining formations in the players’ armies must be set up within 15cms of their own side’s table edge or be kept back “in reserve”. The players take it in turn to set up these formations one at a time, starting with the player with the higher strategy rating.

Units kept in reserve must either be aircraft, or be going to enter play in a transport aircraft or by teleportation. Reserve formations entering play in aircraft or by teleportation should be placed aside with units that will enter play via planetfall. These formations are not “secret” and your opponent may inspect them at any time.

Units being transported must start the game already loaded into the transport vehicle that will bring them into play (i.e., an aircraft or unit with the planetfall ability).

Formations entering play in aircraft or from spacecraft can do so on any turn, following the rules for transport aircraft and planetfall (see 4.2.5 and 4.4). Formations that are in reserve may not carry out *any* game functions or use special abilities they may have.

76. Set-up Remaining Formations

- Q: Are formations being kept in reserve declared at the same time as other formations are being set up within 15cm of their own side’s table edge?
- A: No, players declare which formations are going to be kept in reserve first, then take it in turn to set up the remaining formations one at a time, starting with the player with the higher strategy rating.
- Q: Can the player with the higher strategy rating choose to make their opponent set up a formation first?
- A: No.
- Q: When is it decided how formations in reserve will enter play?
- A: The means by which a formation will be entering play must be declared when they are declared to be in reserve.
- Q: Can formations that aren’t aircraft or entering play via transport aircraft or teleportation be kept in reserve?
- A: Yes, but only if they can enter play via some other special ability (tunneler, self planetfall, etc.).
- Q: Can a formation in reserve activate?
- A: Yes, and it must enter play.
- Q: Is a formation in reserve ever limited in what actions it can carry out?
- A: Yes, it must carry out an action that will allow it to enter play. Sometimes it might be limited to carrying out an engage action (e.g. Eldar in reserve with a Webway Portal in an enemy unit’s zone of control).
- Q: Must a formation in reserve activate?
- A: No, but you may only choose to “pass” on activating a formation if all the unactivated formations for the turn are in reserve.
- Q: Can a formation in reserve with no means to enter play choose to “pass” (e.g. Necrons in reserve with no portal left to use)?
- A: No.
- Q: What happens when a formation in reserve fails its action test?
- A: It must move as part of a hold action to enter play.
- Q: What happens when a formation in reserve fails its action test but can’t enter play (e.g. Eldar in reserve and Webway Portal in an enemy unit’s zone of control)?
- A: It takes a Blast marker, and may not take a hold action. It effectively loses its activation.

75. Setup Spacecraft & Garrisons

- Q: Can the player with the higher strategy rating choose to make their opponent set up a garrison first?
- A: No.
- Q: Can War Engines garrison?
- A: Only if they are in a formation that includes units with a speed of 0cm or immobile, or if they are in a formation where half or more of the units (rounding up) are scouts.
- Q: Can a transport aircraft garrison?
- A: No, they must be kept in reserve.

6.1.7 Victory Conditions⁷⁷

You must check to see if either player has won at the end of the third and fourth game turns. If neither player has won at the end of the fourth turn then the “tiebreaker” rule is used to determine the winner.

Each player is trying to achieve five things known as goals. You win if you have achieved two of these goals in the end phase of turns three or four, and you have achieved more goals than your opponent. The five goals are: *Blitzkrieg*, *Break Their Spirit*, *Defend The Flag*, *Take And Hold*, and *They Shall Not Pass*.

Blitzkrieg: You achieve this goal by capturing the objective that was set up on the opponent’s table edge at the start of the game (i.e., the first objective each player set up).

Break Their Spirit: You achieve this goal by destroying (not breaking) the formation worth the most points in the opposing army. If several formations are tied for the most points, you achieve this goal by destroying any one of them.

Defend To Flag: You achieve this goal if you control all three objectives in your half of the table.

Take And Hold: You achieve this goal by capturing a total of two objectives in your opponent’s half of the table.

They Shall Not Pass: You achieve this goal if there are no unbroken enemy formations in your half of the table.

If neither player has won at the end of the fourth or any subsequent turn then both players roll a D6 to see if the game carries on another turn or ends in a tiebreak. If both players roll the same number then the game carries on for another turn and the players must roll again at the end of the next turn to see if the game ends or carries on another turn, and so on.

If the players roll different numbers then the game ends in a tiebreak. Each player scores a number of *victory points* equal to the full points value of any enemy formations that have been completely destroyed, plus the full points value of any enemy formations that are broken *and* have been reduced to half strength or less, plus half the value of any formation reduced to half strength or less but is not broken, plus half the value of any formation that is broken but is above half strength. Whoever has the higher points score is the winner. For the purpose of this rule, a formation’s “strength” is equal to the number of units in the formation plus the (remaining) damage capacity of any war engines.

77. Victory Conditions

Q: Do formations that are “off board” (spacecraft) or in reserve count towards the Break Their Spirit goal?

A: No. However, a formation that enters play and is destroyed (e.g. an aircraft) would count towards the goal.

Q: Does a whole formation have to be on the opponent’s half of the table to deny the They Shall Not Pass goal? A whole unit?

A: One part of a single unit on the opponent’s half of the table is all that it takes to deny them the They Shall Not Pass goal.

Q: If a formation rallies in the end phase can it deny the opponent the They Shall Not Pass goal?

A: Yes.

6.2 TOURNAMENT ARMY LISTS

“Do not throw your forces blindly into battle. Before committing your forces, examine the situation. Review your own strength, and that of your enemy. Remember your own objectives, and try to anticipate those of your opponent. Then select those of your troops best suited to the task in hand.”

Imperium Tactica

The following army lists are designed to work with the range of models produced by Games Workshop for Epic, and will produce a closely balanced game when used along with the tournament game rules (see 6.1).

Although each army list is based on one particular fighting force, they are typical of many other similar armies, and so all of these lists can be used as “stand in” lists for players that may already have collected an Epic army from a previous edition of the rules.

In order to use the army lists, you and your opponent must agree upon a points total for the game that you will play, and then select formations from the army lists that are equal to or less than this value. For example, you might agree to play a 3,000 point game, in which case you would both pick formations whose points value comes to 3,000 points or less.

The attached army lists provide points value for all of the models available in the Epic range. The “counts as” rule opposite will make it easy for you to use non-standard models in your games, and the appendices at the end of this book include sections on how to use models that are no longer in production from older versions of Epic in your games too. Our aim is to make it as easy as possible for players to use all of the models in their collection without receiving an unfair advantage by so doing, and as long as you use the rules in this spirit you will find your games all the better for it.

Each army list is broken down into four parts:

Forces: This section tells you which datasheets to use from Section 5.0.

Using The Army List: This section tells you how to use the army list, and covers the different types of formation used by the army and how they can be selected from the list.

Special Rules: The special rules that apply to the army list.

The Army List: The army list describes the formations that can be used in the army, the units that make up each formation, and gives a points value for each formation. It also includes the army’s strategy rating and the initiative rating for any formations in the army. The datasheets for all of the units in the armies can be found in the Forces section (see 5.0).

6.2.1

The ‘Counts As’ Rule

You may if you wish decide that certain units in your army “count as” something else from the army lists that is of roughly the same size and function. This is especially useful if you are using old models that are no longer in the range and therefore not covered in the army lists, or you are using models that are painted differently. For example, you might have managed to lay your hands on some of the old metal Ork Squigoth models that we made many years ago but that are now no longer in the range. Rather than leaving these models languishing on the shelf you could simply decide that they “count as” Ork Battlewagons, which are roughly the same size as a Squigoth and have a similar function. Alternatively, you may have decided to use the Steel Legion army list to represent a different Imperial Guard regiment with a very different colour scheme. Again, it would be a great shame not to be able to use your gorgeously painted army, and the “counts as” rule will allow you to do so. However, if you decide to use the “counts as” rule, then there are three very important things to bear in mind:

- First of all, before the game starts you must tell your opponent that you have decided to use the “counts as” rule, and you must let him know what counts as what.
- Secondly, this rule is here to allow you to use all the models in your collection, not as a method of fine-tuning your army for every game that you play. Therefore you may not use the “counts as” rule for units that are actually covered in the army lists. For example, if you have a model of a Land Speeder, then you must use it as a Land Speeder and pay the points for a Land Speeder; you could not use it as a Land Speeder Tornado, or a Predator, or any other unit for that matter. By the same token, a Land Speeder Tornado must be used as a Land Speeder Tornado and can’t stand in for any other units. This rule is included to prevent confusion and keep game play as even and balanced as possible. Note that you can paint the unit in any way you like, you just can’t count it as a different unit from the list.
- Finally, if you decide that any unit in your army “counts as” something else, then all of that type of unit in your army must count as the same thing. For example, if you decided that your old Squigoth model was a Battlewagon, then all the Squigoths in your army would have to be Battlewagons—you couldn’t have one Squigoth as a Battlewagon, one as a Gunwagon, and so on.